

DISTANCE Chapter 04

Equalization and the Living Universe

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May 2026

1 Momentum Structure and Motion

If we do not take the objects that make up the Universe as mutually independent starting points, we can ask a somewhat different question about motion as well. What appears to us as a single object—a stone, a planet, or a star—may itself be a Momentum Structure, an observable configuration in which countless relationships and Momentum maintain a certain degree of coherence. If so, what does it mean for such a Structure to move?

We ordinarily understand motion as a change in the position of an object. A ball rolls across a table. A car travels along a road. A planet moves around a star. An object occupies one position and then moves to another. In this picture, the object comes first. Space also comes first. The already existing object then changes its position within that already existing space.

This description is extraordinarily useful for recording and measuring the motion we observe. Yet the same motion begins to look somewhat different if we do not place space before all relationships as an absolute stage, and if we likewise do not treat the object as an independent entity already complete before those relationships. Position, direction, and distance require relational distinctions, and if an object is a relatively persistent configuration formed by countless Momentum relationships, then far more is changing beneath the familiar statement that “an object moves through space” than a change of coordinates alone would suggest.

Consider a stone. It rests in one place. A moment later, it is somewhere else. We say that the stone has moved. But if we examine what has changed during that interval, it is

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not merely the “position of the stone.” The relationship between the stone and the ground has changed. Its relationships with surrounding objects have changed. The relationship between the observer and the stone has changed. At a larger scale, the relationships between the stone and Earth, and between the stone and other celestial bodies, have also changed. Even the relationships within the stone are not completely isolated from the rest of the Universe.

Read in relational terms, therefore, motion appears first not simply as an independent object changing coordinates on an empty stage, but as a continuous transformation of the relationships between one Momentum Structure and the other Momentum Structures around it. Change of position remains an important result that we can observe and measure. Yet while that position changes, the relationships that constitute the Structure, as well as those connecting the Structure to its surroundings, are changing with it.

Where, then, does the difference lie between a stone that appears to be at rest and the same stone when it begins to move?

In the familiar intuition, the object exists first and then possesses a state of motion. It may move or remain at rest, and when its state of motion changes, we look for the cause of that change. Momentum, however, does not exist only in moving objects. Momentum is also present in a Structure that appears stationary. Nor does a Structure contain only one Momentum. Momentum exists in its internal relationships, and Momentum also exists in the relationships between that Structure and other Structures throughout the Universe.

Momentum is always present.

When a stone that was at rest begins to move, therefore, we do not need to imagine that a Momentum previously absent has suddenly come into existence. What changes is which directionality, among countless coexisting Momentum, becomes effective as the motion presently available to observation.

These Momentum do not operate in isolation. As Difference is resolved at broader scales, countless relationships within those scales are changing at the same time. Changes across a broader relational network alter the conditions under which local Difference and Distance are formed, and consequently alter which of the already existing local Momentum become effective, and to what degree. At the same time, changes within a local Structure also alter its relationships with its surroundings and thereby participate in the continuing rearrangement of the broader network.

Within this process, relatively strong Momentum relationships can form a bound relational configuration. Acting together with other Momentum around them, these re-

relationships continually constrain, cancel, and rearrange one another. Strong Momentum relationships may remain active internally, yet because they are intertwined across multiple directions, the Structure as a whole may exhibit only relatively small change compared with what is occurring around it.

When such a relative lull in observable Momentum persists and becomes distinguishable from its surroundings, we can observe it as an Island, or as a Momentum Structure.

A lull does not mean that Momentum has disappeared. Equalization continues within the Structure. Equalization also continues through the relationships between the Structure and its surroundings. And all of these processes occur simultaneously with changes in Momentum and Equalization unfolding at broader scales. Countless Momentum of different scales and directions coexist within a single Structure, while their relational balance continues to change.

Consider a tug-of-war. Opposing directionalities may exist simultaneously even while the marker at the center remains still. Its lack of movement does not mean that the Momentum on either side has vanished. Different directionalities are acting at the same time and constraining one another, producing a state in which macroscopic displacement is relatively subdued. If the condition on one side changes, that balance changes as well, and the marker begins to move.

Something similar can occur in a Momentum Structure. Momentum remains present even when the Structure appears stationary. And when the Structure moves in one direction, this does not mean that only the Momentum corresponding to that direction exists. Countless Momentum of different scales and directions act simultaneously, while a particular directionality may become more strongly effective under the present relational balance.

Motion therefore need not be understood as a transition between the absence and presence of Momentum. Momentum exists both in states that appear stationary and in states that appear to move. What changes is the relational balance among coexisting Momentum and, within that balance, which directionality becomes observable as motion.

Nor is this process closed within a single local Structure. When Momentum is resolved across a broader relational network, relationships are rearranged, and those changes affect the conditions of local Difference and Distance. Which local Momentum becomes effective may therefore change as well. At the same time, changes in local relationships alter surrounding relationships in return. As changes occurring at different scales overlap in this way, the direction of motion observed in a particular Structure is continually formed

and revised.

This is what it means for Global Momentum and local Momentum to act simultaneously. Global Momentum is not a single enormous Momentum that moves every local Structure in the same direction. Nor is local Momentum an independent fragment detached from Global Momentum. Countless Momentum exist simultaneously at different scales, changing the conditions of different relationships, constraining and canceling one another, and at times reinforcing similar directionalities.

Some local Momentum may become effective in a direction similar to a directionality visible at a broader scale. Others may diverge from it. Still others may even appear, at a particular observational scale, to act in the opposite direction. The possibility of such differences does not make local motion independent of the broader relational network. Rather, the directionality observed in any one Structure emerges within a network in which Momentum at multiple scales are simultaneously intertwined.

Return now to the moving stone.

As the stone travels, we continue to regard it as the same stone. As a planet moves, we continue to regard it as the same planet. Even while countless Momentum are being resolved and relationships with the surroundings are continually changing, some parts of the relational configuration change only slightly compared with the changes around them. As long as that relative persistence is maintained, we can continue to track the configuration as the same Structure.

At the same time, the relationships between that Structure and the surrounding Universe continue to change.

These are not opposing processes. For a Structure to move, neither must all of its relationships remain unchanged nor must all of them change completely. The relational configuration that allows us to distinguish it as a Structure can persist to some degree while the relationships connecting that Structure to its surroundings continue to be reconstructed.

A ball in flight is therefore changing throughout its motion. Its relationship with the air changes, its relationship with the ground changes, and its relationships with surrounding Structures change. Countless internal relationships continue to change as well. Yet because the relational configuration by which we distinguish it as a ball persists sufficiently relative to those surrounding changes, we can say that the same ball has moved along a trajectory.

Conversely, when a strong collision or another relational change substantially reconstructs the existing bound configuration, the boundary of the Structure itself may change.

A stone may break into several pieces, or previously separated configurations may enter new binding relationships. What has changed in such cases is not merely the position of an object. The very set of relationships that constituted one distinguishable Structure has been rearranged.

This distinction is important for understanding motion. The motion of an object can be understood not as a completely fixed entity crossing empty space, but as **a relatively persistent Momentum Structure continually forming different relational states within the changing configuration of a broader relational network**.

From this perspective, Structure and motion are not opposites. A Structure is not a state in which change has stopped. It is a state in which, amid countless simultaneously existing and resolving Momentum, a particular relational configuration persists relative to the changes around it. Motion, likewise, is not an event in which the Structure abandons its stability. It is a process in which the relationships between a relatively persistent configuration and its surroundings continue to change, allowing an observable directionality to emerge.

The same Structure can nevertheless display very different forms of motion. One may sustain motion in a particular direction for a considerable period. The direction of another may change rapidly as surrounding relationships change. Still another may appear to resist changes in its overall state of motion even when substantial relational changes occur around it.

Here a difference appears that motion alone does not yet explain.

Why does one Momentum Structure maintain its relational configuration relatively strongly even as its surroundings change, while another is easily reconstructed by a small disturbance? Why does changing the overall state of motion of one Structure require a much greater rearrangement of relationships than changing that of another?

To understand that difference, we must look at **how the countless relationships within a Momentum Structure are bound together**.

2 Mass — The Density of Binding Momentum

Imagine two balls of the same size. From the outside, they look almost identical. Yet one is hollow, while the other is filled with a heavy material. The difference becomes immediately apparent when we lift them. One rises easily; the other requires much greater force. The same is true when we push them. Given a similar push, the two balls do not undergo the

same change in motion. We express this difference through the physical quantity called mass.

Mass is one of the most familiar and precisely measured quantities in physics. A stone has mass. Earth has mass. The Sun has mass. In general, an object containing more matter has greater mass, and objects of different masses exhibit different changes in motion under otherwise comparable interactions.

There is no reason to replace these measurements or their mathematical descriptions. DISTANCE asks a different question.

What kind of relational difference within a Momentum Structure might correspond to the difference we measure as mass?

If an Island is a relatively persistent configuration formed by countless Momentum relationships, there is no reason to assume that every Island must be organized internally in the same way. In one Structure, a relatively small number of relationships may be loosely connected. In another, far more relationships may be densely intertwined in multiple directions. Both may be observed as individual Islands, yet the relational configurations that sustain them are not the same.

Between the components of a Structure there are Difference and Distance, and Momentum exists in association with those unresolved Distances. These Momentum do not exist as isolated units. When one relationship changes, the conditions of other relationships connected to it also change. A change in one Distance may alter surrounding Distances, and the relational balance among coexisting Momentum may consequently be reconstructed.

When relatively strong Momentum relationships are bound together in multiple directions, a change occurring in one part is especially unlikely to remain confined to that part alone. The states of other parts related to it change as well, and those changes in turn modify the conditions of still other relationships. The moment one relationship changes, multiple connected relationships may therefore be drawn into the same reconstruction.

Here we can introduce the expression ****binding Momentum****.

Binding Momentum does not mean a new force existing inside a Structure like some additional adhesive. Nor is it something externally added to hold components together as an Island. It refers to those Momentum relationships, among the countless relationships constituting a Momentum Structure, that participate strongly in the relative persistence of that configuration. The more strongly connected these Momentum relationships are across multiple directions, the more extensively a change in one part becomes entangled

with changes in other relationships.

At first glance, one might expect a Structure containing many strong Momentum relationships to change more dramatically. If Momentum is strong, its associated directionality should also be strongly expressed. But a complex Structure does not contain only one strong Momentum.

Momentum of many different directions coexist. The Momentum in one relationship acts together with Momentum in others. Some directionalities may reinforce one another, while others constrain or cancel one another. When a change in one relationship alters the Distance of another, the balance among the Momentum that become effective there changes again. The more densely such relationships are intertwined, the more difficult it becomes for one component to change independently of the relationships around it.

Think of a spiderweb.

In a web made of only a few loosely connected threads, moving one thread may produce a change that remains relatively localized. In a densely woven web, however, pulling a single point causes many surrounding threads to respond. Changing the position of one point is no longer a matter concerning that point alone. The lengths and tensions of the threads connected to it change, and those changes extend into other parts of the web.

A Momentum Structure can be considered in a similar way. This does not mean that actual material Structures are literally organized like spiderwebs. What matters is the connectivity of relationships: how much reconstruction elsewhere accompanies a change in any one relationship.

In a Structure composed of relatively few and loosely connected relationships, changes in some relationships may allow the overall relational configuration to change comparatively easily. In a Structure where many binding Momentum relationships are densely connected across multiple directions, by contrast, a single change may require the reconstruction of a much broader set of internal relationships.

This difference is not necessarily visible from the exterior.

Consider two Structures with the same geometric volume. One contains relatively few internal relationships. The other consists of far more components bound through strong relationships extending in multiple directions. Equal spatial size does not imply equal relational organization. In the latter Structure, a relational change occurring in one component may be connected to many more relationships elsewhere.

The ****density**** at issue here is therefore not identical to ordinary spatial density.

In everyday physical language, density commonly refers to how much mass is contained

within a given volume. That is a useful quantity with a precise meaning in physics. By contrast, when we speak of the density of binding Momentum, geometric volume itself is not the primary concern. What matters is how many strong relationships are interconnected within a Momentum Structure and how densely those relationships participate in sustaining its persistent configuration.

Two Structures of the same size may therefore have different relational densities. Conversely, a Structure that is geometrically larger need not possess a higher relational density of binding Momentum. Geometric size and relational density are not the same scale.

Mass can be viewed in relation to this difference.

****Mass can be interpreted as the density of binding Momentum within a Momentum Structure.****

Here, density does not mean simply dividing an “amount” of Momentum by spatial volume. Nor does it mean counting binding Momentum as though it were an independent material substance stored inside the Structure. The expression has a relational meaning: it concerns how densely the relatively strong Momentum relationships constituting an Island are organized, and how extensively a change in one relationship becomes connected to the reconstruction of other internal relationships.

Seen in this way, a Structure with greater mass need not be pictured merely as something that “contains more of something.” The difference in mass can also be read as a difference in the relational organization constituting the Structure. The more densely numerous binding Momentum relationships are intertwined, the more broadly a local change may require reconstruction across the relational network.

Consider a large boulder and a small stone. If we regard them simply as two pieces of matter occupying space, we can say that the larger boulder contains more matter and therefore has greater mass. At the level of observation and measurement, that description remains entirely valid. From the perspective of a Momentum Structure, however, another feature becomes visible. The scale and organization of the relationships participating in the persistence of the larger boulder as a Structure are not the same as those of the smaller stone. More components are related to one another, and countless strong relationships participate in maintaining a single bound configuration.

If one part of the boulder is moved, its relationships with surrounding parts change. To substantially change the state of motion of the boulder as a whole requires a change connected with the wider network of those bound relationships. This does not mean

that every internal relationship must move simultaneously or to the same degree. The important point is that, for a different observable directionality to emerge at the scale of the Structure as a whole, a substantial portion of its relational network must participate under new relational conditions.

The difference becomes far greater when we compare a small stone with a planet.

Represent a planet as a point and its internal complexity disappears. An actual planet, however, is an enormous Momentum Structure in which countless components are bound at many different scales. An atom, a rock, a geological layer, and the planet as a whole participate in relationships at different scales. Among them, countless binding Momentum relationships contribute to the planet's persistence as a distinguishable Structure.

Yet mass cannot simply be called the “number of relationships.”

The existence of many relationships is not enough. Even if an enormous number of relationships exist, if they are only weakly effective they may not participate in a strongly bound Structure in the same way. Conversely, a smaller number of strongly bound relationships may contribute greatly to the relational persistence of a Structure. What matters is not only how many relationships exist, but also their effectiveness and the way they are organized.

The density of binding Momentum therefore contains at least two intertwined aspects. One concerns how densely the relationships constituting a Structure are connected. The other concerns how strongly effective those relationships are in participating in the bound configuration. In an actual Structure, these are less like two independent numerical quantities than two aspects of a single relational organization.

This is not an attempt to redefine mass as a new physical quantity. In established physics, mass is already measured with great precision and functions within well-tested theoretical relationships. DISTANCE does not propose a new unit intended to replace that measured quantity. It proposes an interpretive perspective on what kind of relational configuration within a Momentum Structure might correspond to the observable property we call mass.

The distinction matters.

If “binding Momentum density” were claimed to correspond one-to-one with conventional mass as a new calculable physical quantity, we would need an independent definition and measurement of relational density and a quantitative relation connecting it to measured mass. No such physical theory is being proposed here. The present claim is more limited: rather than leaving mass only as an intrinsic property possessed by an indepen-

dent object, we can also ask whether it can be interpreted through the organization of the binding relationships that constitute a Momentum Structure.

This perspective connects in an interesting way with the relative Momentum lull discussed earlier.

Strongly bound Structures contain strong Momentum relationships. Yet the Structure as a whole may appear remarkably stable. A stone can remain a stone for a very long time, while a planet persists as one planet despite enormous internal change. This is not because Momentum inside them is weak. On the contrary, numerous strong relationships may be intertwined across many directions, constraining the conditions under which one another can change and thereby allowing the overall relational configuration to persist relative to surrounding change.

Strong binding Momentum and a relative Momentum lull are therefore not contradictory. The former concerns how strongly effective the internal relationships are in binding the Structure. The latter concerns how little the overall configuration changes relative to its surroundings as the many relationships act together. Strong Momentum can exist internally while macroscopic relational persistence emerges at the scale of the whole Structure.

This relational organization also matters in interactions with the outside.

A Momentum Structure is not separated from the rest of the Universe. It remains related to other Structures around it and exists within the changing configuration of a broader relational network. When external relationships change, the conditions of internal relationships are affected as well. In a Structure with a high relational density of binding Momentum, however, such a change may become connected to many internal relationships rather than remaining confined to one part.

For this reason, the same degree of external relational change need not reconstruct every Structure to the same extent. In one Structure, a relatively narrow change in relationships may be enough to produce a large change in its overall state. In a densely bound Structure, a substantially broader rearrangement of relationships may be required before a different state becomes observable at the scale of the whole.

We experience an analogous difference in everyday life. Push a light ball and a heavy metal sphere across a table, and the interaction required to produce the same change in motion is different. Physics describes this difference with great precision through the relation between mass and inertia. From the perspective of Momentum Structure, beneath that difference lies an additional interpretive question: how densely bound is the relational

organization that constitutes the Structure?

But mass and inertia should not immediately be treated as the same thing.

Interpreting mass in relation to the relational density of binding Momentum and explaining how easily the observable directionality of a Structure changes under altered external relationships are connected questions, but they are not identical. The former concerns the internal relational organization of the Structure. The latter concerns how that organization appears in changes of motion. They may arise from related aspects of one relational configuration, but the two phenomena still need to be distinguished.

Nor does the relational significance of mass end within the Structure itself.

The binding Momentum relationships constituting an Island do not isolate that Island from the surrounding Universe. Instead, the bound Structure as a whole enters into relationships with other Structures. A small stone is related to Earth; Earth is related to the Sun; and the Sun itself lies within a broader relational network. Within each Structure there are countless binding Momentum relationships, while between Structures there are also Difference and Distance and the Momentum associated with them.

When a densely bound Momentum Structure enters into relation with another Structure, therefore, we need not picture merely two independent points confronting one another. Within each apparent point, countless relationships have already been organized, and changes between the two Structures occur within this more complex relational network.

Viewing mass as the density of binding Momentum brings us to a new question at precisely this point.

How does the densely organized binding structure within one Momentum Structure become manifest in its relationships with another Momentum Structure? When countless relationships are bound into a single Island, what directionality becomes effective between that Island and another?

Once mass is viewed as a problem of relational organization, it no longer ends at the interior boundary of a single Structure. The bound Structure itself becomes part of a wider relational network.

3 Gravity — A Preferred Path of Equalization

Release a stone from your hand and it falls downward. Throw an object from a height and it eventually moves toward the ground. The Moon moves around Earth, and Earth

moves around the Sun. The scales and forms of motion differ greatly, yet we describe all of these phenomena through a single physical relationship: gravity.

Gravity is among the most precisely described phenomena in modern physics. We can calculate the motion of massive objects and predict planetary orbits, while general relativity successfully explains a much broader range of phenomena by relating gravity to the geometry of spacetime. DISTANCE does not seek to replace these descriptions with a new equation of gravity.

Its question is somewhat different.

Why does a particular directionality become effective so repeatedly around a Momentum Structure?

In the previous section, we considered mass in relation to the relational density of binding Momentum organized within a Momentum Structure. A massive Structure is not simply a point. Within it are countless Differences and Distances, and countless Momentum relationships are intertwined into a bound configuration. Nor is that Structure separated from the rest of the Universe. Difference and Distance also exist in its relationships with other Structures, and the corresponding Momentum are effective there as well.

Consider Earth and a small stone.

In the familiar picture, we first place two objects before us: Earth and the stone. Gravity acts between them, and the stone accelerates toward Earth. This picture is extraordinarily useful for calculating motion. Seen relationally, however, Earth and the stone are not connected by only one isolated Momentum.

Countless Momentum relationships exist within Earth. Countless Momentum relationships also exist within the stone. Relationships exist between Earth and the stone, while both are simultaneously related to countless other Structures around them. None of these Momentum is completely independent of the others. When one relationship changes, the conditions of other relationships connected to it also change, and within those changes, which Momentum becomes effective—and to what degree—may continue to change.

Yet objects near Earth's surface move toward Earth with remarkable consistency.

If countless Momentum coexist, why does motion not scatter randomly in every direction?

Here the relational organization associated with mass becomes important. A massive Momentum Structure such as Earth contains a dense organization of binding Momentum relationships, and the relationship between that Structure and a small object is itself part

of this complex relational network. As countless Momentum become effective simultaneously, some directionalities may reinforce one another, others may constrain one another, and still others may largely cancel at the macroscopic scale of observation.

As a result, a particular directionality can become relatively more strongly effective than the others.

We can call such a directionality a ****preferred Equalization Path****.

Here, “preferred” does not mean that the Universe compares several possible paths and then selects the best one. Nor does it imply that the Universe searches for the most efficient route toward some goal. Under already existing relational conditions, some Momentum are more strongly effective than others, and this difference appears as a difference in the paths through which Equalization becomes actual change.

Where effective Distance is shorter, Momentum is more strongly effective. And a more strongly effective Momentum provides a more strongly available path of Equalization under the present relational conditions. A preferred Equalization Path is therefore not the result of Equalization choosing a path. It is the observable dynamical expression of an asymmetry already present among different Distances and Momentum.

This distinction is crucial.

Equalization does not first establish a goal and then reduce Distance in order to reach it. Rather, within the present relationships, stronger effective Momentum corresponds to shorter effective Distance, and that Momentum, acting together with other Momentum, makes a particular resolution path more strongly available.

The relationship between Earth and the stone can be considered in the same way.

The stone does not have only a relationship directed toward Earth. It is related to the surrounding air, to other matter nearby, and to countless more distant Structures. Earth, likewise, is not an isolated mass. It is an enormous Momentum Structure in which countless internal relationships are bound together, and it is simultaneously part of a still broader relational network.

Momentum coexist throughout all of these relationships.

Yet when we observe the motion of a small stone near Earth’s surface, a particular directionality associated with its relationship to Earth becomes strongly effective. This is not because all the other Momentum have disappeared. Rather, under the present relational configuration, the directionality toward Earth is far more prominent than the others in the macroscopic motion of the stone.

When the stone is released, this directionality becomes observable motion.

We see the stone fall.

At this point, however, an important distinction must be maintained. The geometric motion by which the stone approaches Earth cannot simply be identified with a change in effective Distance as DISTANCE uses the term.

As the stone falls, the geometric separation between Earth and the stone decreases. The two Structures visibly approach one another, and the distance measured with a ruler becomes smaller. Effective Distance, however, is not geometric separation itself. It is a Distance associated with how strongly effective Momentum is within a relationship.

The fact that the stone moves toward Earth therefore does not by itself imply that effective Distance is decreasing in the same direction.

On the contrary, as Momentum is actually resolved, the effective Distance corresponding to that Momentum increases. This does not contradict the geometric convergence of the stone toward Earth. One describes a change in observable spatial separation; the other describes a change in effective Distance associated with the resolution of relational Momentum.

If these two kinds of Distance are placed on the same scale, the DISTANCE interpretation of gravity is easily reversed.

To say that “gravity is a process that reduces the Distance between two objects” mixes geometric distance with effective Distance. To go further and say that “Equalization moves toward minimum Distance” reverses the causal relation itself.

What we observe spatially in gravitational motion may indeed be geometric convergence between two Structures. Yet in the relational process underlying that motion, already strongly effective Momentum appears as a preferred resolution path, and as that Momentum is resolved, the corresponding effective Distance can increase.

Imagine a stone rolling down a hillside.

Draw its trajectory on a map and it appears as a line leading from higher ground toward lower ground. We do not look at that line and say that the stone “chose” the lower ground. The slope, the condition of the stone, its contact with the ground, and numerous surrounding physical conditions already make one form of motion far more strongly available than others.

An Equalization Path can be understood in a similar sense.

The path, however, is not a geometric road drawn in advance. As relational conditions change, which Momentum is strongly effective also changes, and the directionality through which Equalization preferentially appears can therefore change continuously.

When a Structure moves, its relationships with its surroundings change; those changes reconstruct the configuration of Difference and Distance, and the balance among coexisting Momentum is reconstructed in turn.

Actual gravitational motion is therefore not a process of following a single fixed arrow.

In the simple case of a stone falling toward Earth, the direction may appear almost constant. The motion of celestial bodies is far more complex. A planet is related to its star, to other planets, to its satellites, and to countless surrounding materials. Momentum exists in each of these relationships, and those Momentum simultaneously affect the conditions under which the others become effective.

Even so, under particular relational conditions, one directionality may become far more strongly observable than the others.

It is precisely this repetition that makes gravity appear so strongly to us as an independent force. From the perspective of Momentum Structure, however, that repetition need not arise because the underlying relationships are simple. It can instead be understood as the persistent emergence of a particular strongly effective directionality amid countless simultaneously existing relationships.

This also allows us to view the significance of a massive Structure somewhat differently.

If mass is related to the relational density of binding Momentum, a massive Structure can be read as a Momentum Structure containing a more densely organized configuration of binding relationships. Such a Structure is not a simple point but an Island in which many relationships persist together as one distinguishable configuration.

When that Island enters into relationship with another Structure, the external relationship is not independent of this bound whole.

To say that a small stone is related to Earth need not be limited to the picture of one small point interacting with one large point. Countless relationships constituting the enormous Momentum Structure we call Earth persist as one bound configuration, while the stone also exists as a Structure with its own internal relationships. The observable directionality between the two Structures is formed within this complex relational network.

This does ****not****, however, mean that “mass makes effective Distance shorter.”

Such a simple causal relation between mass and Distance would make it appear that mass exists first, directly compresses the surrounding Distance, and thereby causes Momentum to become stronger. The claim required here is much more limited. Within the complex relational network formed when a densely bound Momentum Structure relates

to other Structures, some Momentum may become more strongly effective than others under the present relational conditions. When the resulting directionality is repeatedly observed, we recognize it as gravitational motion.

The direction that appears to point toward Earth's "center" requires the same care.

Place a small object near the nearly spherical Earth and its motion generally points toward Earth's center. It is therefore easy to imagine that the center exists first and somehow pulls the object toward itself. Yet the geometric reference we call the center need not be identified directly with the origin of relational directionality.

The countless relationships constituting Earth are distributed spatially in nearly every direction. When the relationships between that whole Structure and a small object are observed at a macroscopic scale, effects in some directions may reinforce one another while those in other directions substantially cancel. The result can be an observable directionality that aligns closely with what we geometrically describe as the direction toward Earth's center.

The center is an extraordinarily powerful geometric reference for expressing that directionality.

But the geometric center itself need not be regarded as the cause that generates Momentum.

This distinction becomes increasingly important when motion grows more complex. In simple free fall, one directionality is so strongly expressed that gravity can appear to have a permanently fixed direction. But when the relationships between Structures change and several Momentum become effective at comparable levels, the observable directionality can also change continuously.

Even within a gravitational relationship, Structures do not remain still while gravity acts upon them. The relational network continues to be rearranged. The motion of one Structure changes its geometric relationship with another, and that change in turn affects which Momentum becomes strongly effective. Local change modifies surrounding relationships, and changes in those surrounding relationships become part of the broader relational configuration. The preferred Equalization Path within that configuration is therefore not fixed either.

Gravity can thus be read not as a single eternally fixed line, but as **a phenomenon in which a particular directionality of Equalization becomes repeatedly and strongly effective while countless Momentum simultaneously act and are resolved within the relational network formed by complex Momentum Structures**.

What we call “attraction” is one way in which this relational process becomes observable as geometric motion.

A stone falls toward Earth. The geometric separation between the two Structures decreases. A planet continually changes its position around a star. Celestial bodies alter one another’s directions of motion. These observations remain fully valid.

Beneath them, however, countless Momentum coexist, constraining, reinforcing, and canceling one another, while the effectiveness of each Momentum continues to change as the relational network changes. Among them, a particular directionality repeatedly becomes more strongly effective than the others, producing the observable motion we call gravity.

Seen this way, gravity no longer remains a strange action detached from mass. The question of how binding Momentum is organized within a Momentum Structure leads directly to another question: which directionality becomes strongly effective in the broader relational network that the Structure forms with other Structures?

One problem, however, still remains.

Even while multiple Momentum continue to act upon a Structure, its present direction of motion may appear difficult to change. If gravity shows the relational conditions under which a particular directionality becomes strongly effective, we must also explain why a directionality that is already effective can persist.

Why does a Momentum Structure appear so reluctant to change its present state of motion?

4 Inertia — The Idealization of Unmodified Relations

In the previous section, we considered gravity as a preferred directionality of Equalization that appears within a relational network containing complex Momentum Structures, as countless Momentum are simultaneously resolved and constrain one another. Local Equalization continues within a Structure, Momentum is resolved in its relationships with other Structures, and all of these relationships unfold together with global Equalization at broader scales. In the actual Universe, therefore, the Momentum acting within the relationships of a Structure is never singular. Momentum of different scales and directions coexist, and their relational balance produces the effective direction presently observed.

What, then, happens if the relational balance among these Momentum does not change

substantially?

The directionality currently appearing as effective should likewise remain largely unchanged. This provides a way to reconsider inertia.

In classical mechanics, an object upon which no external force acts remains at rest or continues to move in a straight line at constant velocity. This is one of the most fundamental and powerful principles for describing motion. What DISTANCE asks is how the condition “no external force acts” should be understood relationally.

Imagine an object completely separated from the Universe. If no relationship exists between it and anything else, then there would be nothing external to alter its motion. Yet such a picture is difficult to establish within the framework developed so far. A Momentum Structure is itself constituted through relationships, and it simultaneously participates in relationships with other Structures. Even an object that appears isolated remains part of a broader relational network.

This does not invalidate the classical concept of inertia.

Rather, it suggests that the condition of no external force can be understood as an idealization in which the relational effects capable of substantially modifying the presently effective directionality are sufficiently small to be neglected.

Consider a puck sliding across an almost frictionless surface. If the effects of friction and air resistance are sufficiently small, its direction and speed remain nearly constant over a considerable interval. We describe the puck as continuing its motion through inertia. Yet the puck is not actually without relationships. It remains related to the surface, the air, Earth, and countless other Structures. Momentum exists in all of those relationships.

The relevant question is not whether those relationships exist, but how strongly their changes reconstruct the directionality presently effective in the puck’s motion.

If changes in the surrounding relational network continually produce substantial differences in the effective Momentum of the puck, its motion changes noticeably. Its speed may increase or decrease, or its direction may bend. If, however, those changes are sufficiently small in relation to the directionality already effective, the observable motion may continue with little modification.

Inertia can therefore be read not as the absence of Momentum, but as the persistence of an effective directionality when relational changes capable of modifying it remain relatively small.

This distinction matters because Momentum never disappears merely because motion

looks uniform.

A Structure moving at constant velocity is not a Structure from which Momentum has vanished. Nor is a Structure at rest free of Momentum. Countless Momentum continue to coexist in its internal relationships and in its relationships with the surrounding Universe. What differs is the relational balance through which those Momentum become observable.

A state of rest can therefore be considered alongside uniform motion.

Suppose a book rests on a table. It does not fall through the table, nor does it suddenly accelerate sideways. Yet this does not mean that no Momentum exists in the relationships involved. The book is related to Earth, to the table, to the air, and internally to the countless components that constitute it as a Structure. Different directionalities coexist and constrain one another. At the observational scale of the book as a whole, their relational balance can produce a state in which macroscopic displacement is negligible.

If that balance is altered sufficiently, the state changes.

Tilt the table and the book may begin to slide. Remove the table and it may fall. Push it sideways and another directionality becomes strongly effective. Momentum did not suddenly come into existence at the moment motion began. What changed was the relational configuration within which particular Momentum became effective as observable motion.

The same reasoning applies to an object already moving.

If a Structure is moving in a particular direction and the surrounding relationships do not significantly modify that directionality, its motion continues in approximately the same form. The persistence does not require the Structure to “remember” its previous motion, nor does it require an internal tendency to defend its state. The presently effective directionality simply continues to be expressed while the relational changes capable of substantially reconstructing it remain small.

This allows us to distinguish inertia from a tendency toward self-preservation.

It is tempting to say that an object “wants to keep moving” or “resists being moved.” Such expressions are useful in ordinary speech, but they can easily introduce purpose into a physical relationship. A Momentum Structure does not need to possess an intention to maintain its state. Inertia can instead be understood through the relational conditions under which an already effective directionality undergoes little modification.

The connection with mass now becomes clearer.

In Section 4.2, mass was interpreted in relation to the density of binding Momentum within a Momentum Structure. In a Structure where many strong binding Momentum

relationships are densely interconnected, a change in one relationship may require the reconstruction of many others. Altering the observable motion of the Structure as a whole may therefore involve a broader relational rearrangement than it would in a more loosely organized Structure.

From outside, this difference appears as a difference in how readily the state of motion changes.

A Structure with greater mass does not possess a mysterious determination to preserve its motion. Rather, if its observable motion is associated with a densely organized relational configuration, substantially changing that motion may require the reconstruction of a correspondingly broader set of relationships. In this sense, the relation between mass and inertia can be interpreted through the same underlying organization of a Momentum Structure.

This does not mean that mass and inertia are being replaced by one newly defined physical quantity. Established physics already relates them with extraordinary precision. The DISTANCE interpretation is more limited: the observed resistance to changes in motion can be read as an expression of how extensively the relationships constituting a Momentum Structure must be reconstructed for a different directionality to become effective at the scale of the Structure as a whole.

The greater the relational reorganization required, the more persistent the existing observable state may appear.

Yet even this persistence is never absolute.

Every Momentum Structure remains embedded in relationships of multiple scales. Changes within the Structure alter its relations with its surroundings, while changes in the broader relational network modify the conditions under which local Momentum become effective. Global and local processes therefore continue simultaneously even when the motion of a Structure appears almost perfectly uniform.

This point prevents inertia from becoming a disguised form of isolation.

A Structure need not escape from the relational network in order to move inertially. It need not reach a region where every other relationship has vanished. What matters is that, within the scale and duration of observation, the combined relational changes affecting its present effective directionality remain sufficiently small that the resulting modification can be neglected.

This also explains why inertia depends on the observational frame.

A Structure that appears stationary relative to one observer may appear to move

uniformly relative to another. The physical significance of inertia does not require one of these observations to reveal an absolute state while the other is merely apparent. What persists is a relational pattern: within a chosen observational relation, the effective directionality changes little enough that the motion can be described as uniform.

The observer is therefore not standing outside the relational network.

Observation itself establishes a relation. Position, velocity, and direction are described relative to some reference Structure or coordinate system. Different observational relations may produce different descriptions of the same Structure's motion, while the relational conditions that generate those descriptions remain part of the same Universe.

Inertia is not a special phenomenon that appears only when one of these relationships disappears. Even while many relationships coexist, inertial persistence can appear whenever the changes that modify the present observable directionality remain relatively small. Depending on which relationship an observer uses as a reference, that persistence may appear either as rest or as uniform motion.

For the same reason, the phrase **“a state without relational change”** must not be taken literally.

There is no need to imagine a Structure in the Universe for which every relationship has completely stopped changing. Changes continue within the Structure, and its relationships with the surroundings are not perfectly fixed. The important question is not whether **all relationships remain unchanged**, but how strongly their changes reconstruct the effective directionality currently being observed.

In this sense, inertia is better understood not as a state in which relational change is absent, but as **an idealized limit in which the relational effects that would alter the present state of motion are small enough to be neglected**.

A perfectly inertial state is difficult to find in reality. No matter how remote a Structure may be, it is not completely detached from all other relationships in the Universe. Very weak Momentum continue to exist, and the conditions of the relational network continue to change. Yet if such changes are sufficiently small within a particular observational scale and range, we can neglect them and describe the Structure as maintaining its state of motion.

Idealization does not deny reality. It allows a pattern to become clear by temporarily setting aside effects that are comparatively small for the phenomenon under consideration. Like a perfectly straight line, a perfect vacuum, or a completely isolated object, a perfectly inertial state need not imply that all real relationships have actually disappeared. It can

instead be understood as a physical limit obtained by treating particular relational effects as sufficiently small.

From this perspective, the meaning of inertia shifts slightly.

Inertia is not the absence of Momentum. It is not a state in which a Structure has escaped from the relational network of the Universe. Nor is it a property through which a Structure actively seeks to preserve its own condition. It is the observed persistence of a directionality when, amid countless coexisting Momentum, no relational change becomes sufficiently prominent to substantially modify the directionality presently effective.

This leads to a very simple case.

Suppose a particular directionality is already effective in a Momentum Structure, while changes in the surrounding relationships continue without significantly modifying that direction. What kind of trajectory would the Structure display?

The relational network still exists. Momentum has not disappeared. Only the present effective direction remains substantially unchanged over the range of observation.

The simplest observable expression of such persistence is a straight line.

5 Linear Motion — Dominant Equalization

Inertia did not require a state in which Momentum had disappeared. Countless Momentum remain present within a Structure, in its relationships with surrounding Structures, and across the broader relational network in which it is embedded. What appears as inertial motion is instead a condition in which changes in those relationships modify the presently effective directionality only slightly. If that condition continues, the directionality observed at one moment can remain similar through the changes that follow.

This immediately raises a simpler question. What spatial form would such continuity take?

Suppose that, among the many Momentum acting simultaneously within a relational network, one directionality appears dominantly effective. A Structure changes in that direction. As it changes, its relationships with its surroundings also change, so the next relational state cannot be identical to the previous one. Yet if the reconstructed relational network still contains no other Momentum strong enough to modify the dominant directionality substantially, the next change will occur in approximately the same direction. If this pattern continues, a succession of relational changes will preserve a similar effective direction.

Observed spatially, that succession appears as a trajectory close to a straight line.

Linear motion therefore need not begin from a principle separate from inertia. In a relational network containing multiple coexisting Momentum, one effective direction can become dominant while modifications from other Momentum remain sufficiently small. When that condition persists through successive changes in the network, the observable trajectory approaches a straight line.

The straight line, in this sense, is not a path laid down in advance.

Nothing in the Structure needs to identify a geometric line ahead of itself and follow it. Nor does Equalization select the shortest spatial route after comparing alternatives. At each relational state, numerous Momentum coexist, while their continuously changing balance determines which directionality becomes effective. A straight trajectory appears when the direction that emerges from that balance is modified only slightly as one relational state gives way to the next.

This distinction separates a straight geometric path from the process that produces it.

A line drawn on paper is a geometric object. Linear motion, by contrast, is an observed continuity of relational change. The line becomes visible only when successive changes are represented spatially and their effective directions remain nearly aligned. What is fundamental to the present interpretation is therefore not the preexistence of the line, but the persistence of a dominant directionality through changing relational conditions.

Consider a small object moving through a region where the effects capable of altering its present motion are extremely weak at the scale of observation. Its relationships do not disappear. The object remains part of the Universe, and Momentum remain present both internally and externally. But if the changing relational network produces only negligible modification of the currently effective direction, the object continues to be observed along an almost straight trajectory.

This is the familiar physical situation idealized in uniform linear motion.

Established mechanics describes such motion with exceptional precision. In an inertial frame, an object subject to no net force maintains constant velocity. DISTANCE does not dispute this description. It asks what the persistence of direction may mean when the object is understood as a Momentum Structure embedded in a network of relationships rather than as an independent entity moving against an empty background.

The answer does not require the disappearance of every other Momentum. It requires only that their combined effects fail to reconstruct the dominant observable directionality

to a significant degree.

This point becomes clearer if we compare several relational situations.

Imagine first that a Structure has one strongly effective directionality while other Momentum acting upon it are relatively weak or largely cancel one another. As the Structure changes, the surrounding relationships are reconstructed, but the same general balance persists. The effective direction at the next state therefore differs only slightly from the previous one. Repeated over many changes, the resulting trajectory remains nearly straight.

Now imagine that another Momentum becomes increasingly effective. The relational balance no longer produces the same directionality. The next change is tilted slightly away from the previous one. As this continues, the trajectory begins to curve.

Nothing discontinuous needs to occur between these two cases. A straight trajectory and a curved trajectory can arise from different degrees of modification in the effective direction as the relational network is repeatedly reconstructed.

A perfectly straight line is therefore a limiting case.

In the actual Universe, no Structure is completely isolated. Global Momentum and numerous local Momentum coexist. Equalization continues within an Island, in its relationships with neighboring Islands, and across broader relational scales. Their directions need not coincide. Some Momentum may reinforce the direction presently effective in a Structure, while others may modify it from the side or in the opposite direction. Still others may largely cancel at the scale at which the Structure is being observed.

The trajectory appears straight to the extent that these other effects produce sufficiently little directional modification.

This also means that “dominant” must be understood carefully.

A dominant Momentum is not the only Momentum that exists. Nor does dominance mean that all other Momentum have become physically irrelevant. It means that, under the present relational configuration and at the scale of observation, one directionality contributes most strongly to the motion that becomes observable, while the remaining Momentum alter that direction only within a comparatively small range.

The observable Universe is therefore not divided into regions where Momentum exists and regions where it does not. What changes is which Momentum becomes effective within a given relational configuration and how the balance among coexisting Momentum is expressed as observable directionality.

Linear motion is one especially simple expression of that balance.

This helps explain why the same Structure can appear to move linearly over one interval but not over another. The Structure itself need not acquire or lose some intrinsic property of “straightness.” Instead, the relational conditions around it change. Over a limited interval, modifications to the dominant direction may remain too small to matter. Over a longer interval, the accumulated effects of other Momentum may become observable, and the trajectory that once appeared straight may gradually curve.

The scale of observation matters as well.

A trajectory that looks perfectly straight over a short distance may reveal curvature when observed across a much larger distance. Conversely, motion that belongs to a large curved trajectory may appear nearly linear within a sufficiently small region. The distinction does not arise because one observation is real and the other false. They reveal the same relational change at different scales, where the accumulated modification of effective direction becomes observable to different degrees.

Consider the motion of a planet for only a very short interval. Its orbital trajectory can be approximated by a straight line. Extend the observation, and the continuing modification of its direction becomes unmistakable. The planet did not alternate between two fundamentally different kinds of motion. The difference lies in whether the relational effects modifying its effective direction become significant over the scale being observed.

The same reasoning applies more broadly. Whenever one directionality remains dominant while other Momentum modify it only weakly, the spatial trace of successive relational changes tends toward linearity. As those modifying effects become stronger or persist long enough to accumulate, the trajectory departs increasingly from the straight-line limit.

Linear motion can therefore be understood as **the observable form of relational change in which one directionality of Equalization remains dominant while competing or intersecting Momentum produce only small modifications to its effective direction**.

Here again, Equalization must not be imagined as choosing the straightest route.

The straight trajectory does not arise because Equalization seeks geometric simplicity, minimum length, or efficiency. A shorter effective Distance corresponds to a more strongly effective Momentum, and the balance among such Momentum determines which directionality is more strongly available under the present relational conditions. If that balance repeatedly preserves a similar effective direction, the resulting motion appears linear. The geometry is the observable expression of that persistence, not the objective toward which the process is directed.

This distinction also prevents geometric distance from being confused with effective Distance.

A Structure moving along a straight line may become geometrically closer to one Structure and farther from another. Those changes in spatial separation do not by themselves determine whether the corresponding effective Distances are increasing or decreasing. Effective Distance concerns the relational effectiveness associated with Momentum, not simply the length of the geometric path traced through space.

The straightness of a trajectory therefore tells us primarily about directional persistence, not about a universal tendency toward shorter geometric or effective Distance.

Within a real relational network, however, perfect directional persistence is exceptional. A Structure is simultaneously related to many other Structures, and those relationships continue to change. Momentum that were initially weak may become more strongly effective. Momentum that largely canceled one another may cease to do so. A change within the Structure itself may alter how its relationships with the surroundings are reconstructed. Changes at broader scales may also modify the conditions under which local Momentum become observable.

Global and local processes occur together.

A local Structure participates in broader changes while its own relational changes feed back into the surrounding network. There is no need to imagine a global process acting first and local motion following afterward, nor a local trajectory developing independently before affecting the larger network. Momentum at different scales coexist, constrain one another, and are resolved simultaneously. What appears as a straight line is a temporary relational condition within this continuously changing network.

This is why straight motion is physically important without being the universal template from which every other motion must be derived.

Its simplicity comes from the relative stability of effective direction. When directional modification becomes sufficiently small, a straight trajectory emerges naturally as the spatial representation of successive relational changes. But once other Momentum become strongly effective enough to alter that direction continuously, another form of motion appears.

Suppose, for example, that a Structure has a dominant directionality that would, under nearly unchanged relational conditions, produce a straight trajectory. At the same time, however, another persistent Momentum repeatedly modifies that direction. The Structure changes, the relational network is reconstructed, and the dominant direction

at the next state is no longer exactly the same as before. Yet the modifying relationship also persists, so the direction is altered again at the following state.

If this reconstruction continues, the Structure does not simply abandon one straight path and select another. Its effective direction is continuously renewed through the interaction of multiple Momentum.

The resulting trajectory bends.

And when the conditions producing that directional reconstruction persist in a sufficiently organized form, the bending itself can become persistent.

That is where rotation begins.

6 Rotation — Continuously Reconstructed Directionality

Imagine a ball that has been moving in a straight line, but whose direction begins to change little by little. A single small correction may leave almost no visible difference in its trajectory. If the same kind of directional modification continues, however, the path traced by the ball gradually bends. And if that modification is repeatedly sustained within a stable relational condition, the ball may continue moving around a region without ever proceeding directly toward a single point.

We call this rotation.

Rotation is so common that its familiarity can conceal what is unusual about it. Wheels rotate, tops spin, planets turn on their axes, and satellites orbit planets. The scales differ enormously, and the physical conditions sustaining each motion are not the same. Yet they share one geometric feature: the direction in which the moving Structure proceeds is continuously changing.

This distinguishes rotation from the linear motion considered earlier.

In approximately linear motion, one directionality remains dominant while other Momentum modify it only slightly. The Structure changes its relational state as it moves, but the effective direction emerging from the reconstructed relationships remains close to the previous one. A straight trajectory is the geometric expression of that relative directional persistence.

Rotation requires something more.

A Structure may have a directionality that would, by itself, continue approximately straight. Yet another Momentum relationship may simultaneously modify that direction.

Once the Structure changes position, the relational configuration is no longer exactly what it was before. The effective direction must therefore be formed again within the newly reconstructed relationships. If a similar directional modification continues in the next state, the trajectory bends again.

What persists in rotation is thus not one fixed direction.

It is ****the relational condition through which directionality continues to be reconstructed****.

This distinction is easy to miss because a rotating Structure can display remarkable regularity. A planet may orbit a star for an immense period. A wheel may turn repeatedly around the same axis. The repetition can make rotation look as though a circular path already exists and the Structure merely follows it. But the trajectory itself does not explain why the direction changes at every moment.

At every point along a curved path, the Structure has a presently effective direction of motion. If nothing modified that direction, the motion would continue approximately along the corresponding straight line. For curvature to persist, some other effective Momentum must continually participate in reconstructing the directionality.

Established physics describes these situations through well-developed dynamical concepts. Circular motion can be analyzed through velocity, acceleration, force, angular momentum, torque, and the particular interactions relevant to the system. Planetary orbits, rotating rigid bodies, and spinning particles cannot simply be reduced to one identical mechanism. DISTANCE does not replace these descriptions or claim that every form of rotation is physically generated in the same way.

Its reinterpretation concerns a more general relational feature beneath their different mechanisms.

Whenever a trajectory curves, the effective direction observable in the Structure is not simply preserved. It is repeatedly modified as the relational configuration changes. When that modification itself persists through a relatively stable set of relationships, curved motion can continue rather than appearing as a single temporary deflection.

Consider a satellite orbiting Earth.

At any given moment, the satellite is moving in a particular direction. If the relationship that continually modifies this direction were negligible, its trajectory over the relevant interval would approach a straight line. Yet its relationship with Earth remains effective. As the satellite moves, its geometric relation to Earth changes, and the direction in which that relationship becomes observable changes as well. The direction of motion

is therefore reconstructed again and again.

The satellite does not need to stop, turn, and start again at each point. Nor does one Momentum disappear so that another can replace it. Multiple Momentum coexist. The observable trajectory results from their continuously changing balance.

Rotation is therefore not a sequence in which linear motion repeatedly fails.

The straight-line tendency and the direction-modifying relationship coexist. The Structure continues to move while the effective direction of that movement is continually reconstructed. What appears geometrically as curvature is the observable trace of this persistent relational modification.

A spinning object reveals the same principle in a different configuration.

Take a point near the rim of a rotating wheel. At one moment, the point moves upward; later, sideways; later still, downward. No single geometric direction remains dominant throughout the rotation. Yet the motion is not directionless or random. The changing directions are constrained by the relational organization of the wheel.

The point is not independent of the rest of the Structure. Its relationships with neighboring parts, with the axis, and with the wheel as a whole limit the ways in which its motion can change. As the wheel rotates, the effective direction of the point is continuously reconstructed within those persistent binding relationships.

This reveals an important difference between changing direction and losing Structure.

A Structure can undergo continuous directional change while maintaining a relatively persistent relational configuration. Indeed, in rotation, persistence of the bound configuration can be precisely what allows directional reconstruction to repeat. If every relationship inside the Structure were completely reorganized at each moment, there would be no reason for a stable rotational pattern to continue.

A rotating Structure is therefore both changing and persistent.

Its parts continuously occupy different geometric relations to the surroundings, and the observable directionality of those parts continually changes. Yet enough of the internal relational configuration persists for the changing directions to remain coordinated as one rotational motion.

This coexistence of persistence and change is especially clear in a rigid wheel, but the same interpretive principle need not be confined to rigid objects. A vortex, a planetary system, or another rotating configuration may consist of components whose internal relationships are far less fixed. The relevant physical mechanisms differ, but rotation still requires some relational organization through which directional modification persists

rather than becoming arbitrary.

The word ****persistent**** is important here.

A single collision can deflect a moving ball. Its trajectory changes direction once and then may continue approximately straight along a new path. That is not what we ordinarily mean by sustained rotation. For rotation to emerge, the relation that modifies direction must itself remain effective as the Structure continues to change.

The modifying Momentum therefore cannot be understood as a one-time instruction given to the Structure.

As the Structure moves, the relational network changes. The Momentum effective within that network are correspondingly expressed under new conditions. The next direction emerges from the new relational balance, which is then changed again by the subsequent motion. Rotation is maintained through this continuous reconstruction.

This makes a rotating trajectory fundamentally relational without requiring a mysterious rotational substance.

Nothing called “rotation” needs to be stored inside the moving Structure as an independent entity. Nor must the Structure know the shape of the trajectory it will trace. Rotation appears when multiple Momentum remain related in such a way that the observable directionality continues to be modified while the relational configuration sustaining that modification persists.

This also explains why different forms of rotation can have very different shapes.

If directional modification remains approximately uniform relative to the motion, the trajectory may approach a circle. If the strength or orientation of the relevant relationships changes, the path may become elliptical or otherwise curved. If the relational configuration becomes unstable, the rotational pattern itself may change or disappear.

The geometry records the outcome of these relational differences.

It does not determine them in advance.

This is particularly important when a rotating Structure is embedded in a broader network. No rotation occurs in complete relational isolation. A wheel is related to its axle, vehicle, ground, and surroundings. A planet is related not only to its star but also to other planets, satellites, and the wider astronomical environment. A rotating Island contains internal binding Momentum while simultaneously participating in Momentum relationships extending beyond its own boundary.

Changes at these different scales occur together.

A local rotational pattern can persist while broader relationships slowly modify it.

Conversely, changes within the rotating Structure can alter its relationships with the surrounding network. The observed rotation is therefore neither simply imposed from a global level nor produced by a completely independent local mechanism. It appears within the continuing interaction of Momentum at multiple scales.

For long periods, these interactions may permit an extraordinarily stable pattern. At other times, a relatively small change in one relationship may accumulate until the rotational configuration is noticeably altered. The axis may shift, the orbit may precess, the period may change, or the Structure may cease to remain bound in the same way.

Rotation is consequently not a finished state.

It is a dynamically maintained pattern of directional reconstruction.

This point becomes clearer if we imagine two Momentum acting in different directions. If one remains overwhelmingly dominant and the other contributes almost nothing observable, the trajectory approaches a straight line. If the second Momentum becomes effective only briefly, the trajectory is deflected. If, however, the relationship associated with that directional modification remains effective as the Structure changes, the effective direction is reconstructed repeatedly, and sustained curvature can emerge.

The transition from straight motion to rotation therefore need not require two unrelated principles. Both can be interpreted through the changing balance of coexisting Momentum. In one case, a dominant directionality persists with little modification. In the other, the relational configuration continually modifies that directionality in an organized way.

The difference lies in the persistence of directional reconstruction.

Yet once rotation continues, another feature becomes difficult to ignore. The direction of motion keeps changing, but the changes often appear organized around something. A wheel turns around an axle. A planet rotates around an axis. A satellite orbits around a planet. Even when no material object occupies the exact geometric point involved, we describe the motion with reference to a center.

It is tempting to regard that center as something that already exists and causes the surrounding motion.

But perhaps the order can be read differently.

If a center is repeatedly revealed by the coordinated reconstruction of many directional relationships, the center may not need to be the starting cause of rotation. It may instead be a reference that becomes observable through the organization of those relationships themselves.

7 Center — A Reference Created by Relationships

When we watch a rotating ball, its center seems unmistakable. The ball turns around its center. A wheel rotates around an axis, a planet moves around a star, and an object on Earth's surface has a direction that points toward Earth's center. After seeing such phenomena repeatedly, it is easy to feel that the center must exist before the rotation does, as though the center were already there and the surrounding motion were then organized around it.

Geometry makes this intuition even stronger. For a circle, we can identify a point that lies at the same distance from every point on the circumference; for a sphere, we can likewise define a point from which the radius is the same in every direction. Once coordinates are assigned, the position of that center can be specified precisely. A center defined in this way is extraordinarily useful for describing motion.

But when we ask what a center means in a rotating Momentum Structure, the order can be viewed somewhat differently.

The essential feature of rotation was not that a Structure first finds an already existing center and then moves around it. Multiple Momentum coexist within and around the Structure, while changes in their relationships continuously reconstruct the effective direction. When this reconstruction forms a recurring pattern, the motion appears rotational. Within that recurring pattern, a relationship that remains relatively persistent can then become observable as a central reference.

The center, in other words, need not be what produces rotation.

Rotation can reveal a center.

Consider several points on a rotating wheel. Each point continuously changes its position. Its direction of motion also changes. A point that is moving upward at one moment may later move sideways and then downward. If we look only at the individual directions, everything seems to be changing.

Yet when these changing directions are considered together, something comparatively persistent appears. The distances and directional relations of the points to a particular reference follow a repeated pattern. The points move, their directions change, and their geometric positions are continually reconstructed, but the changing relationships can still be expressed relative to one persistent reference.

That reference is what we call the center.

The center therefore does not need to be an independent entity hidden inside the Structure. It can be understood as a reference that emerges when continuously changing

relationships exhibit a recurring organization.

This becomes especially clear when the center contains no material object at all.

Imagine a rotating ring. Matter exists along the ring, while the geometric center may be empty. Nevertheless, the center remains indispensable for describing the rotation. Every point on the ring changes its position relative to that center in a regular way, and the repeated directional changes of the points can be expressed concisely through that single reference.

If the center itself were the physical source of the rotation, an empty center would be difficult to understand. But if the center is a relational reference, there is no difficulty. Nothing material needs to occupy the point. The bound relationships of the rotating Structure connect the modifications of direction, and their recurring pattern can be represented through a common reference.

The center compresses that pattern.

It is therefore closer to a relatively persistent relational reference among changes than to an unchanging entity.

This distinction matters. If the center is placed first as an independent entity, the surrounding motion naturally seems to require explanation from that center. The center pulls the surroundings, creates their directions, or somehow organizes the rotation. If the center is instead understood as a relational reference, the explanatory order changes. Multiple Momentum coexist; their effective directions continually change within their relationships; and when some relation persists repeatedly across those changes, a central reference can become visible.

The center does not create Momentum.

Momentum exists before a center is defined.

Nor does the center first create local Difference or Distance. The relational network already exists and continues to be reconstructed. When some relationship remains relatively persistent through that reconstruction, a center becomes useful as a geometric representation of that persistence.

Earth provides a particularly clear example.

At almost every point on Earth's surface, we describe "downward" as approximately the direction toward Earth's center. For a person in the Northern Hemisphere and another in the Southern Hemisphere, downward points in different directions if both are compared with a single absolute direction in outer space. Yet when the two directions are described in relation to Earth as a Structure, they reveal a common feature: both can be represented

as pointing toward Earth's center.

The center thus becomes a powerful reference through which directions observed at very different locations can be expressed within one relational pattern.

This does not mean that Earth's center independently creates every one of those directionalities. As considered in the discussion of gravity, observable directionality emerges within a complex relational network containing countless coexisting Momentum. The center provides a remarkably concise geometric reference for expressing the recurring pattern in those directions.

The distinction between reference and cause must therefore remain clear.

A coordinate system can describe motion with extraordinary precision, but its origin does not generate the motion it describes. In the same way, the fact that many directions can be expressed relative to a center does not by itself establish that the center is the source from which those directions originate.

The position of a center can also depend on which relational configuration is being observed.

A rigid, symmetric body may have a geometrically obvious center. In a more complicated Structure, different definitions of center may be useful for different purposes. The geometric center, center of mass, center of rotation, and a common orbital reference need not always coincide. Established physics distinguishes these concepts precisely, and there is no reason to collapse them into a single physical entity.

Their differences instead reinforce the relational character of the reference.

Which center becomes useful depends on what relationships are being observed and at what scale they are being organized. A particular center may express one recurring pattern extremely well while another reference becomes more appropriate for a different pattern.

The Earth–Moon system makes this especially clear. If we look only at the Moon's motion relative to Earth, Earth's center provides a useful reference. If we describe the motion of Earth and the Moon together, however, another reference associated with their common motion becomes important. If the entire solar system is considered at a broader scale, still other relationships become relevant.

A center that is effective at one scale does not invalidate centers at another.

Each center expresses recurring motion and configuration within a particular relational scale. A local center can itself move when observed within a broader relational network, and both its position and its significance can change as the scale of observation changes.

There is therefore no reason to extend the center of a particular Structure into an absolute origin of the Universe.

The fact that a center appears with great clarity within one Structure does not require the entire Universe to possess a single center in the same sense. A center is meaningful because a particular relational configuration makes it meaningful.

This also prevents us from treating the center as merely arbitrary.

If a center is not an independent substance or causal source, it might seem that we could place it anywhere we wish. But a useful center is constrained by the relationships it represents. In a stable rotational pattern, only certain references compress the changing positions and directions into a simple recurring organization. Move the reference elsewhere and the description may become much more complicated.

The center is therefore neither an absolute entity outside relationships nor an arbitrary label imposed without constraint. It is a reference made effective by the persistence of particular relationships amid continuing change.

This is why a center can remain meaningful even when the Structure itself changes.

A rotating body may deform slightly. Its axis may shift. An orbit may change gradually under the influence of other relationships. In such cases, the center used to describe the motion may also move. The reference is not required to remain eternally fixed. What matters is whether it continues to capture a relatively persistent pattern within the changing configuration.

The fact that the center can move does not make it unimportant.

Quite the opposite.

A center is valuable precisely because it can compress the complex motion of many parts, whose positions and directionalities are continuously changing, into a common reference. Once the center is known, we can compare the rotational radii of different parts, identify patterns in directional change, and describe the motion of the Structure as a whole far more concisely.

But concise description must not be allowed to replace cause.

Just as the origin on a map does not create the city, the center of a coordinate system does not generate the motion. A reference allows us to read relationships. It need not be an independent source that creates them.

The relation between center and Momentum can now be stated more clearly.

Multiple Momentum coexist within and around a Momentum Structure, and their effectiveness continually changes as relationships change. Some directionalities reinforce

one another, while others constrain or cancel one another. Local changes alter the conditions of surrounding relationships, while changes in the broader relational network also affect the configuration of local Difference and Distance. Through these simultaneous changes, observable directionality is continuously reconstructed.

When that reconstruction develops a particular recurrence, a center can become an effective reference. The center can therefore be understood not as the source of Momentum, but as ****a reference through which we can observe and express the recurring relationships produced by changes among coexisting Momentum****.

This interpretation avoids mystifying the center while leaving it with more significance than a mere geometric convenience.

A center is not an absolute entity existing outside relationships, but neither is it a name that can be assigned indiscriminately. When some relation remains relatively persistent amid countless intertwined changes, the center can provide the most concise reference for expressing that persistence.

Nor must there be only one such center.

Different centers can become effective as the Structure and scale under observation change. A human body considered as a rotating Structure can have motion described around a particular axis. Earth's rotation makes its rotational axis and center important. The Earth–Moon relationship may require another reference through which the motions of both Structures can be represented together. At the scale of the solar system, still other relationships become significant.

One center does not invalidate all others.

Each expresses recurring motion and configuration at a different relational scale. A local center can itself become a moving reference within a broader relational network, while its position and significance change within larger-scale relational transformations.

A center that changes position is still a center if it continues to provide a useful reference for a recurring relational pattern.

The more consistently such a pattern is maintained, the more clearly the center can be defined. And as the center becomes clearer, the surrounding relationships are increasingly likely to appear as a recurring geometric pattern.

The center, then, does not end as a single point.

When many relationships surrounding that reference begin to share similar conditions, a distinctive form can emerge in the configuration as a whole.

We encounter that form repeatedly throughout the Universe.

The circle and the sphere.

8 Circles and Spheres — Relational Structures of Equivalent Distance

Look across the Universe and forms close to circles and spheres appear with remarkable frequency. Stars and planets are broadly spherical. Under certain conditions, the orbits of satellites and planets approach circular forms, while traces of circularity appear in many rotating astronomical Structures. At much smaller scales, liquid droplets can also approach spherical shapes.

These phenomena are not produced by the same physical cause. The shapes of astronomical bodies are explained through relationships involving gravity, pressure, rotation, and other factors, whereas surface tension plays an important role in the shape of a liquid droplet. Established physics describes each of these phenomena precisely through different conditions and laws.

Yet a question remains.

Why do similar geometric patterns—circles and spheres—appear repeatedly across such different scales and physical conditions?

The simplest answer begins with geometry. A circle is the set of points lying at the same geometric distance from a center, and a sphere extends that relation into three dimensions. The relation between center and boundary does not depend on direction. Whichever direction is chosen, the radius is the same.

This definition tells us exactly what an already formed circle or sphere is. It does not by itself explain why such forms appear repeatedly in physical Structures.

The question becomes more interesting when viewed through the relations considered so far.

Suppose one directionality remains much more strongly effective than the others within a Structure. The observable configuration is then likely to develop an asymmetry associated with that direction. A Structure may extend farther in one direction, become compressed in another, or continue to change along a particular orientation. As long as one direction remains relationally privileged, there is no reason for the resulting configuration to become symmetric around a center.

But the situation can be different.

Suppose Momentum become simultaneously effective in many directions, while their

directional effects constrain or cancel one another so that no single direction can persistently dominate the overall configuration. If the relational conditions around a center become progressively more similar across directions, the relational differences capable of sustaining a persistent bias toward one side also diminish.

One of the simplest geometric expressions that can appear under such conditions is a circle.

In three dimensions, it is a sphere.

“Equivalent relational conditions” does not mean that every relationship is completely identical. Nor does it mean that every Difference, every Distance, and every Momentum within an actual Structure in the Universe must have exactly the same value. If perfect symmetry were required, most of the circles and spheres we observe in reality would immediately fall outside the description.

What matters is ****a sufficient reduction in the difference of relational dominance among directions****.

If no Momentum in one particular direction persistently dominates the observable configuration, while effective Momentum in multiple directions form sufficiently similar relational conditions, the geometric relations between center and surroundings can also become similar across directions. The resulting configuration can approach a circle or a sphere.

At this point, however, geometric distance and effective Distance must again be kept distinct.

Every point on a circle lies at the same geometric distance from its geometric center. The same is true of the surface of a sphere. This is a geometric fact defining those forms. But it does not follow that all of those points necessarily have the same effective Distance from the center.

Effective Distance is not ruler-measured separation.

Two relationships may have the same geometric length while Momentum within them have different effectiveness. Their constituent materials may differ, their relationships with surrounding Structures may differ, and their internal binding conditions may differ. Occupying the same radius does not automatically make their entire relational conditions identical.

The significance of circles and spheres in DISTANCE must therefore be stated more carefully. They are not forms created because Equalization makes effective Distance geometrically equal in every direction. Rather, they can appear when the differences among

multidirectional relational conditions become sufficiently small that their resulting configuration is expressed geometrically with approximate directional symmetry.

This distinction prevents geometry from being silently substituted for the relational process.

A circle is geometrically characterized by equal radii. A sphere is characterized by the same relation extended across three dimensions. But the physical process through which an actual Structure approaches such a form depends on the specific relationships acting within that Structure. DISTANCE does not replace gravity, pressure, surface tension, material properties, or other established physical mechanisms with a generic principle of “becoming round.”

Its claim is narrower.

Across physically different mechanisms, there can be a recurring relational condition in which no single direction remains sufficiently dominant to sustain a strong directional asymmetry in the overall configuration. When the relationships become more nearly equivalent across directions, a circular or spherical geometry can become one observable expression of that reduced directional Difference.

This also clarifies the relation between a circle and a sphere.

Consider a two-dimensional plane around a center. If the relation from that center to the surrounding configuration becomes approximately equivalent across directions, the resulting boundary can approach a circle. Extend the same relational condition through all available directions in three dimensions, and the corresponding configuration can approach a sphere.

A sphere therefore need not arise from a principle fundamentally different from that of a circle. It is the three-dimensional expression of a configuration in which center-to-surrounding relations become directionally similar across a wider range of possible directions.

In this sense, both circles and spheres can be connected with a Distance Structure in which directional Difference has become relatively small.

This relation can also be considered in connection with the formation of an Island.

As Equalization proceeds across broader relational scales, numerous local Difference and Momentum remain effective within that process. Among them, relatively strong Momentum relationships can become bound into a persistent relational configuration. As these relationships constrain, cancel, and rearrange other Momentum, a relative Momentum lull can appear at the scale of the whole, allowing the configuration to be observed

as an Island.

The Momentum relationships constituting such an Island need not be the same in every direction.

An Island therefore does not have to become a circle or sphere.

A crystal can have sharply defined edges. A rock can remain highly irregular. A galaxy may be flattened or elongated. A living body may develop an extraordinarily complex asymmetric form. The persistence of an Island requires neither circularity nor spherical symmetry.

But when relational conditions become increasingly similar across multiple directions and differences associated with particular directional dominance become smaller, directional asymmetry in the observable Structure can also diminish. If such Equalization becomes expressed in spatial form, a configuration approaching a circle or sphere can emerge.

Circles and spheres are therefore neither the purpose of an Island nor its inevitable final form. They are relational forms that can appear when directional Difference becomes relatively small within multidirectional Momentum relationships.

This allows us to consider within one interpretive frame why approximately circular and spherical forms can recur from tiny droplets to enormous astronomical bodies without claiming that the same physical mechanism produces them all.

The specific physical relationships remain different in each case. Surface tension is crucial to a droplet. The large-scale shape of a star or planet involves gravity, pressure, rotation, material distribution, and other conditions. An orbit has yet another dynamical description. These differences cannot be erased merely because similar geometry appears.

What can be compared is the relational pattern.

When many directions participate simultaneously and the Difference privileging one particular direction becomes relatively small, the relation from a center can appear increasingly symmetric with respect to direction. Under relational conditions in which no one direction remains persistently special, a form with similar center-to-boundary relations across directions becomes prominent: a circle in two dimensions, a sphere in three.

In this sense, circles and spheres can be regarded as representative symmetric Structures in which equivalent Distance relations become spatially observable.

But again, “equivalent Distance” must not be interpreted as a claim of exact equality in effective Distance at every point.

What becomes observable as geometric symmetry is the result of many relationships

acting together. Their effective Distances may differ locally, and Momentum may remain strongly effective within the Structure. What matters at the scale of the overall configuration is that those differences do not produce a sufficiently persistent directional dominance to destroy the approximate symmetry.

A spherical star, for example, is not relationally identical in every microscopic direction. Its interior contains enormous variations in density, temperature, composition, pressure, and motion. Rotation can produce flattening. Magnetic fields can introduce directional differences. Surrounding Structures can affect it asymmetrically. Yet at a sufficiently broad observational scale, its overall configuration may still remain close to spherical.

The same logic applies to a droplet. Molecules are not arranged in perfectly identical relationships, nor does every microscopic Momentum have the same direction or effectiveness. Nevertheless, under suitable conditions, directional differences in the macroscopic boundary can become small enough for the droplet to approach a sphere.

Perfect circles and perfect spheres are therefore closer to limiting forms than to ordinary realities in the Universe.

Every actual Structure contains local Momentum. Momentum also exists in its relationships with other Structures, while broader global Momentum remain effective as the relational network continues to change. These relationships are exceedingly unlikely to be exactly identical in every direction. Real Structures consequently display distortion, flattening, protrusion, irregularity, and asymmetry.

Rotation itself can create new directional Difference. Relationships with neighboring Structures can make one direction more strongly effective than another. Internal binding configurations may also differ from one region to another. A form that is nearly spherical at one scale may reveal substantial asymmetry when examined at another.

The appearance of approximate circles and spheres can therefore be understood as the coexistence of two processes: a relational condition in which directional Difference has become relatively small, and the continuing production and reconstruction of new directional Difference.

The same global/local relation remains intact.

While Difference becomes smaller at one scale, new Difference can emerge at another. Symmetry can increase in one relationship while asymmetry increases elsewhere. Local Equalization does not require the broader relational network to become uniformly symmetric, nor does a broadly symmetric configuration require every local relationship within

it to be equivalent.

Equalization is therefore not a simple linear process in which every Difference disappears one after another until the Universe reaches a completely homogeneous final state. The resolution of Difference rearranges the relational network, and that rearrangement reconstructs the conditions under which other Difference and Momentum become effective.

Circles and spheres appear within this continuing process.

Their symmetry does not indicate that Momentum has disappeared. On the contrary, numerous Momentum can remain strongly effective within a nearly symmetric Structure. What has diminished is not directionality itself, but the degree to which one direction persistently dominates the configuration as a whole.

This point also connects circles and spheres back to rotation and the center.

In rotation, Momentum of different directions continually reconstruct the effective direction. If bound relationships persist sufficiently, those directional changes can form a recurring relational pattern. When the relation to a center remains approximately constant within that pattern, circular motion becomes observable. When the relational differences between center and surroundings become small across many directions, a Structure approaching a circle or sphere can appear.

Rotation, center, circle, and sphere are therefore not completely separate phenomena. They are connected relational forms that can arise as multiple Momentum constrain, cancel, and rearrange one another through multidirectional Equalization.

A straight line appeared when one effective directionality remained dominantly persistent. Rotation appeared when Momentum of different directions continually reconstructed the effective direction. Circles and spheres can appear when, within such multidirectional relationships, the differences in relational dominance with respect to a center become sufficiently small to produce a symmetric configuration.

Yet symmetry does not eliminate directionality.

A Structure moving around a circle has a directionality at every moment. Countless Momentum remain effective within a spherical Island. Direction remains present; what may disappear at the scale of the overall configuration is the persistent privilege of any single direction.

The symmetry of circles and spheres is therefore better understood not as ****the absence of direction, but as a relative reduction of directional dominance****.

And at precisely this point, a familiar distinction appears when the same rotational

relationship is read with reference to its center.

Some changes appear to point inward, toward the center. Other aspects of the same motion appear to point outward, away from it. These two directionalities have long been given different names.

Centripetal and centrifugal.

9 Centripetal and Centrifugal — Two Observational Directions of Distance Change

Two directions become especially clear when we observe a rotating Structure. One appears to point toward the center, while the other appears to move away from it. When we spin a ball attached to a string, we say that the string pulls the ball inward. Inside a turning car, our body seems to be pushed outward. When describing a planetary orbit, we likewise consider both the relation directed toward the center and the direction in which the planet is already moving.

We have long distinguished these two directions as centripetal and centrifugal.

In established physics, however, the two concepts do not have the same status. Centripetal force refers to the net inward force required for circular motion, whereas centrifugal force is treated as an inertial force that appears in a rotating reference frame. It would therefore be inaccurate to place them side by side as two equivalent physical forces acting in opposite directions.

DISTANCE likewise has no need to begin by dividing them into two independent Momentum. What occurs in rotation is the continuous reconstruction of effective direction as the relational balance among the many Momentum within and around a Momentum Structure changes. The center emerged as a relational reference through which that repeated directional change could be expressed. Centripetal and centrifugal can therefore be read as ****two observational components that become distinguishable when an already formed rotational relationship is viewed in opposite directions relative to that center****.

Consider again a ball attached to a string.

At every moment, the ball has a present direction of motion. At the same time, it remains bound to the hand through the string. If the ball continues slightly along its present directionality, the geometric relation between the ball and the hand changes. The binding relation through the string continues to participate in reconstructing the ball's effective direction, so the direction of motion changes again as the ball moves.

The current directionality and the relation that modifies it therefore coexist.

When these are viewed relative to the center, two directional aspects become visible. One is the relational contribution that continually modifies the present directionality toward the center. The other appears when the present motion continues without that modification, or when the modification is insufficient, allowing the geometric relation to the center to change outward.

The former appears centripetal.

The latter can appear centrifugal.

But this should not be converted into a picture in which two independent Momentum pull against each other.

Rotation cannot be reduced to the exact balancing of a centripetal Momentum against a centrifugal Momentum. Countless Momentum coexist within a Structure, and as their relational conditions change, observable directionality is continuously reconstructed. Centripetal and centrifugal are directional components distinguished within this complex change by taking the center as the reference.

A spinning top makes this point especially clear.

Different parts of the top move in different directions. At one moment, a part on one side may be moving to the right while a part on the opposite side moves to the left. Each part has its own instantaneous direction of motion, yet because of the binding Momentum relationships within the Structure, those parts cannot simply continue their directions independently of one another. The movement of each part changes its relationships with neighboring parts, and those changes participate in modifying the effective direction again.

Now imagine that the top is rotating rapidly enough for one piece to break away.

The detached piece need not fly directly outward along a radial line from the center. Instead, it may continue along a trajectory related to the direction it had at the moment of separation. As that motion continues, its geometric separation from the center of the top increases.

Seen from a distance, it is natural to say that the piece has been “thrown outward.”

But that description alone does not require us to conclude that a new, independent outward centrifugal Momentum suddenly came into existence.

What changed was the relationship.

The binding relation that had made the piece participate in the rotation of the existing Structure was greatly weakened or broken. The relational conditions that had continu-

ously modified its effective direction therefore changed, and with them changed which directionality among the already existing Momentum became observable.

This does not mean that centrifugal behavior is explained by an absence of Momentum.

Momentum is always present.

Even after the binding relation is broken, the detached piece remains related to countless Structures throughout the Universe, and multiple Momentum remain effective within those relationships. What has changed is how strongly particular relationships participate in the presently observable directionality. The outward-looking change is therefore not a state in which one relationship has disappeared and nothing remains. It is a result of the reconstruction of the relational network and the corresponding change in effective directionality.

This distinction becomes especially important when we consider a planetary orbit.

Suppose a planet is orbiting a star. At every moment, the planet has a present direction of motion, while Momentum associated with its relationship to the star participates, together with other Momentum, in continually reconstructing that directionality. The trajectory therefore continues to curve.

There is no need to picture this motion simply as a static balance between an inward-pulling force and an outward-pushing force.

The fact that a planet remains in orbit does not mean that two forces have perfectly erased one another so that no change occurs. Quite the opposite: the observable directionality is continuously changing. The planet continually changes position, its geometric relation to the star changes, and its effective direction is repeatedly reconstructed within a relational network in which many Momentum coexist.

The inward and outward aspects become distinct when this dynamic relationship is decomposed relative to the center.

At this point, however, the word **Distance** again requires care.

If centripetal and centrifugal are immediately defined as “Momentum that decreases the Distance to the center” and “Momentum that increases the Distance from the center,” geometric distance can easily become confused with effective Distance.

Movement toward the center does not necessarily mean that the effective Distance of the corresponding relationship decreases. Conversely, geometric movement away from the center does not by itself establish that effective Distance increases.

Effective Distance is associated with the relational effectiveness of Momentum. The

inward and outward directions that we directly observe in rotation, by contrast, first concern differences in position and motion relative to the center as a geometric reference.

The “change in Distance from the center” discussed in centripetal and centrifugal observations must therefore be read first as ****an observable geometric relation****.

Once this distinction is maintained, a seemingly puzzling situation becomes quite natural.

In a Structure following a nearly circular orbit, geometric separation from the center can remain almost constant. Does this mean that both inward and outward change have disappeared?

No. The instantaneous direction of the Structure continues to change. As its relationship with the center participates in that directional modification, a difference continually arises between the geometric relation that would result if the present motion simply continued and the next relation actually produced through the reconstructed direction. Through the accumulation of these continuous modifications, rotation can persist while geometric separation from the center changes very little.

An almost constant distance from the center therefore does not mean that relational change has stopped. Rotation continues precisely through repeated directional reconstruction. The effective direction changes at every moment, and the relationships between the Structure and the surrounding Universe are reconstructed with it. A nearly circular orbit is not a state without change, but a case in which directional change forms a recurring pattern.

In an elliptical orbit, by contrast, geometric separation from the central reference itself can continually change. There are intervals in which the Structure moves closer and others in which it moves farther away. Yet it would be wrong to conclude that only the centripetal component exists while the Structure approaches the center and only the centrifugal component exists while it recedes.

The same relational network continues to exist.

Multiple Momentum remain effective simultaneously, while their balance changes with position and with the changing relational configuration. What we distinguish as inward and outward are portions of this continuous motion in which the geometric relation to the center changes in different directions.

Centripetal and centrifugal are therefore not two independent actions that alternately switch on and off. They are distinctions that appear when one rotational relationship is read from different directions relative to its center.

The same perspective can be applied inside a rotating composite Structure.

Consider one part of a wheel. Its position continually changes, while its geometric separation from the center of the wheel remains nearly constant. If that part simply continued along its present directionality, its relation to the center would change. But the binding relationships of the wheel, acting together through its other parts, continually modify that directionality.

Relative to the center, this modification contains a centripetal component. From within a rotating frame, an outward effect can simultaneously be distinguished. Yet if these two observations are each converted into independent entities, the relational change occurring within one bound Momentum Structure is once again decomposed into a competition among separate forces.

DISTANCE seeks to retain the relationship before that decomposition.

The Structure is already part of a Universe in which many Momentum coexist. Changes across the broader relational network affect the relational conditions in which the Structure exists, and within those changes the configurations of local Difference and Distance are also reconstructed. Local changes in the rotating Structure, in turn, alter its surrounding relationships. The observable rotational pattern emerges as these changes at different scales coexist and interact.

The inward and outward aspects are references within that continuing reconstruction, not independent principles standing outside it.

This is why the breaking of a string is so revealing. While the string remains intact, its binding relation continually participates in modifying the effective direction of the rotating ball. Once the string breaks, the relational condition that sustained that modification changes abruptly. The ball then continues under a different balance of the Momentum already present in its relationships.

From the previous rotating frame, the resulting motion may look strongly outward. But what occurred does not require the Universe to create a new outward principle at the instant of separation. The relationships changed, the effectiveness of the coexisting Momentum changed with them, and a different observable directionality emerged.

The same basic fact applies when part of a rotating Structure breaks away or when an orbital relationship changes substantially.

Relations change. The effectiveness of multiple Momentum changes accordingly, and observable directionality changes with it.

The center provides one reference through which we read those changes. Directional

modification toward that reference can be read as centripetal, while geometric change away from that reference—or an outward effect observed in a rotating frame—can be read as centrifugal. The two observations have different names and, in established physics, different formal status, but the underlying relational picture does not require the Universe to alternate between two separate fundamental principles.

Countless Momentum coexist within and around a single Momentum Structure, and their effectiveness changes continuously as relationships are reconstructed. In rotation, that changing balance continually reconstructs effective direction, while the relational reference we call the center makes two aspects of that reconstruction especially visible: inward and outward.

Centripetal and centrifugal are, in this sense, two different faces that a single rotational relationship presents when viewed relative to its center.

10 Time and Space — Observational Scales of Momentum Resolution

When we watch a rotating wheel, we naturally record its motion in two ways. We use space to indicate where a point on the wheel is, and time to indicate how quickly that position changes. We do the same with the orbit of a planet: we record where it was, how far it moved, in which direction it moved, and how long the change took.

This is why it is difficult to speak of motion without time and space. Even when distinguishing mass and gravity, inertia, linear motion, and rotation, we ultimately rely on position and distance, direction and duration. To compare different motions, we need to know how far a Structure has moved, how quickly its direction has changed, and how long a particular state has persisted.

Motion therefore makes it seem almost self-evident that every change takes place within time and space. Space appears first as a stage on which Structures are placed, and as time passes, their positions on that stage change. The picture is so familiar that it seems to require almost no explanation, and few frameworks are more powerful for observing and calculating motion.

Yet when the motions considered so far are placed back into this picture, an interesting difference appears.

What we first encountered when a Momentum Structure moved was a change in relationships. The relationship between one Structure and another changed, while rela-

tionships within the Structure itself continued to be reconstructed. Within those changes, which Momentum became strongly effective could also change, and so could the observable directionality.

In linear motion, modification of that directionality remained sufficiently small. In rotation, directionality was continuously reconstructed. The center appeared as a reference through which recurring relations among those changes could be expressed, while centripetal and centrifugal became distinct when the same motion was read in different directions relative to that reference.

What was changing throughout all of these cases was the relational configuration.

There is therefore no need to bring time back in as the cause of that change. The fact that a ball occupies another position one second later does not mean that the second itself pushed the ball there. Nor does the fact that a planet moves through a certain angle during a day mean that the day caused the planet to move.

Change comes first, and time is used as a scale through which changes are compared.

The difference may sound small in language. We commonly say that an object moved “as time passed,” and there is nothing problematic about that expression in ordinary use. But if the phrase is read as a physical causal sequence, it can make time appear to advance first and change to occur because of that advance.

From the perspective of a Momentum Structure, the explanatory order can be read differently. Relationships among Structures change; the configuration of Difference and Distance changes; the effectiveness of coexisting Momentum changes; and as Momentum is resolved, the relational network is reconstructed. We compare those changes, establish their order, and express their relative degree.

That is where time becomes necessary.

A clock makes this character especially clear. A clock does not create time as an active cause of change. It uses a relatively regular physical change—the oscillation of a pendulum, the vibration of a quartz crystal, or transitions associated with atoms—as a reference and compares other changes with it.

When we say that a car traveled one hundred kilometers in one hour, the “one hour” need not be imagined as something that flowed independently of the car from outside the Universe. Operationally, we compare the change in the car’s position with recurrent physical changes selected as a temporal reference. We ask how fast one change occurs relative to another, how long one state persists relative to another, and which change precedes or follows another.

Time makes such comparisons possible.

In this sense, time can be read as an **observational scale of change**.

Calling it a scale does not reduce time to a human illusion. Temporal measurement is physically real and indispensable for comparing changes among different observers and systems. In modern physics, time is a central variable in the description of motion, energy, and relativistic phenomena, and the consequences of those descriptions have been tested with extraordinary precision.

What DISTANCE changes is not the validity of temporal measurement, but its explanatory priority.

The fact that something can be measured does not make it the first cause of the phenomenon being measured. A thermometer does not create thermal motion by measuring temperature, and a map does not separate two cities by representing the distance between them. In the same way, the extraordinary precision with which time describes change does not by itself require time to be the cause that produces change.

Time allows changes to be compared, and once that comparison is sufficiently stable, the intensity of changes occurring in different Momentum Structures can be expressed on a common scale. The same geometric displacement observed within a shorter temporal reference is described as faster motion. A large change of direction occurring within a short reference interval appears as rapid rotation. Conversely, when a relational configuration changes very slowly relative to the chosen reference, a Structure may appear to remain almost unchanged for a long period.

What we call fast or slow in temporal language is therefore, at this level of interpretation, a **comparison between changes**: how much one change appears relative to another change used as a reference.

Rest can be understood in the same way. A stone lying on a table may exhibit almost no macroscopic displacement while countless internal relationships continue to change. Earth persists as one Structure while relationships within it and between it and its surroundings are continually reconstructed. When a particular change is sufficiently small at the observational scale we have chosen, we describe the Structure as stationary or persistent.

The rate of change measured through time is therefore always connected with what we choose to observe as change and what physical process serves as its reference.

Space presents a similar problem.

To say that a ball moved from here to there, “here” and “there” must be distinguish-

able. To speak of the distance between two Structures, we must distinguish them and measure their geometric relation. To specify a direction, we must determine one side or another relative to some reference.

Spatial description therefore always requires distinguishable relationships.

If a single point were completely isolated, it would be difficult to say where that point was. Whether it lay to the left or right, whether it was near or far, and even whether it had moved or remained still would require another reference for comparison. Once a second Structure is present, a relation between the two can be distinguished. As more Structures become involved, distance, direction, arrangement, and form can be described with increasing richness.

As relationships become more complex, spatial distinctions become richer as well.

In this sense, space need not be understood only as an empty container into which objects are placed. It can also be read as a way of geometrically distinguishing and expressing the relationships among multiple Structures.

This does not mean that geometric space does not exist or that spatial measurement is somehow unreal. We measure spatial distances. We record positions with extraordinary precision, and coordinate systems allow us to describe the motion of celestial bodies and particles with remarkable accuracy. Geometric space is an extraordinarily powerful framework for organizing physical observation.

Again, the question concerns explanatory priority.

We can say that the relationships changed because a Structure moved from one point in space to another. From the perspective of Momentum Structure, however, we can also begin with the changing relationships and ask how those changes become observable as changes in geometric position and separation.

At the level of observation, these two descriptions need not be mutually exclusive.

Suppose two people are standing next to one another on Earth's surface. Relative to a reference fixed to the surface, both may travel a considerable distance as Earth rotates, while relative to each other their positional relation may remain almost unchanged. Which spatial description is correct?

Both are.

They describe different geometric relations because they use different references.

The center considered earlier revealed something similar. The center of a rotating wheel moves continuously relative to the road, yet within the wheel it can remain a stable reference for describing rotation. Its geometric position need not be fixed to an

absolute coordinate of the Universe for its relational significance to persist.

Space, too, is difficult to read independently of such references. Position and direction, distance and shape always imply distinctions and comparisons between something and something else.

Space can therefore be viewed as a ****complexity scale of relationships****.

Here, complexity does not simply mean that a larger number of Structures exists. It means that a network containing many Structures connected through different Distance and directionality permits far more spatial distinctions than a single relation does. Front and back, inside and outside, near and far, center and periphery, straight and curved, circle and sphere all become meaningful because multiple relationships are configured differently.

The richer the relational configuration, the more spatial distinctions can become observable.

From this perspective, space can be read not merely as a passive empty box in which change takes place, but as a scale through which a complex relational network becomes distinguishable as observable geometry.

Time and space therefore perform different roles. Time allows us to compare the degree, order, and relative intensity of change, while space allows us to distinguish positional, directional, and configurational differences among relationships. One provides a scale for comparing change; the other expresses differences in relational configuration geometrically.

Neither, however, needs to be placed before Momentum Resolution as the cause that first produces change.

When a Momentum is resolved, relationships change, and those changes affect the configuration of the surrounding relational network. Within changes across the broader network, the conditions of local Difference and Distance are also reconstructed, while local changes in turn participate in the reconstruction of surrounding relationships. As these changes continue simultaneously across different scales, we observe and compare them through the common scales of time and space.

The same event can consequently appear very different depending on the observational scale. Extremely complex relational changes may be occurring at the atomic level while a macroscopic Structure appears almost stationary. Countless local changes may continue within a planet while, from a great distance, the planet persists for a long period as almost the same spherical Structure. Conversely, a Structure may undergo a large change in

macroscopic position while part of its internal relational configuration remains relatively persistent.

This does not make time and space arbitrary. It means instead that the time and space we actually measure always require particular physical references and observational conditions. Different observers can compare measurements not because there are no standards, but because comparable physical processes and relationships can be defined with great precision.

Modern physics has developed this comparison to an extraordinary degree.

DISTANCE has no reason to deny that achievement. It simply changes the starting point of the explanation.

The Universe does not change because time flows. Nor must we assume that space first unfolds and Structures then begin to relate within it. Difference and Distance are already present in the relational network, and Momentum is always present. As the effectiveness of coexisting Momentum changes and Momentum is resolved, the relational configuration continues to be reconstructed. We use time as a scale for comparing those changes and space as a scale for geometrically distinguishing the differences among those relationships.

What we call a single motion can therefore be read at two levels simultaneously.

At the observational level, a Structure moves from one position in space to another over a certain interval of time. We measure velocity and acceleration and calculate trajectories and directions. These descriptions remain valid.

At the level of DISTANCE interpretation, the balance among coexisting Momentum changes, an effective directionality becomes observable, and the relational network is reconstructed through Momentum Resolution.

Time and space are not false scales that conceal those changes. On the contrary, they are extraordinarily powerful interfaces through which complex changes can be compared and observed.

The distinction is simply that an interface need not be mistaken for a cause. Just as a clock does not cause change, time need not cause Momentum Resolution; just as coordinates do not create relationships, space need not be the first cause of relational change.

Relationships change, and their configurations are reconstructed. As those changes accumulate and recur, Momentum Resolution proceeding across different scales becomes observable as an immensely long history.

The configuration we call the Universe today is not separate from that history.

11 The Big Bang — Global Diffusion of Momentum

The Big Bang is commonly described as the beginning of cosmic expansion. The early Universe was extremely hot and dense, and as the cosmic scale factor increased, the macroscopic separations among matter, radiation, and the galaxies that later formed also increased. Modern cosmology does not describe this simply as an explosion in which matter flew outward into preexisting empty space. It describes the changing geometry of spacetime together with the evolving states of matter and energy within it, and this framework has been developed through extensive observation and precise theoretical work.

DISTANCE does not revisit the Big Bang in order to deny that successful description.

It asks whether the explanation of this enormous change must necessarily begin with the expansion of space itself.

If time and space can be read as observational scales of Momentum Resolution, the transformation from the early Universe to the Universe we observe today can be approached in a different explanatory order. Rather than beginning with space becoming larger and relationships changing as a consequence, we can begin with Momentum being resolved within an extremely concentrated relational network, the resulting relational configuration being rearranged, and that rearrangement becoming observable to us as large-scale spatial separation.

From this perspective, the most important feature of the early Universe is not simply that it was “small.”

The early Universe was an extremely dense physical state. Read in the language of DISTANCE, it can be interpreted as an extreme relational concentration in which vast numbers of relationships were strongly effective. Numerous Differences were tightly intertwined, effective Distance was short across many relationships, and the corresponding Momentum could therefore be strongly effective.

This does not mean that the early Universe contained one enormous Momentum pointing outward.

Momentum is always present, and the Universe is composed of countless coexisting Momentum. Even under an extremely concentrated relational configuration, different relationships can contain different Differences, Distances, and directionalities. The crucial feature is that the relational conditions under which those Momentum were effective differed radically from those of the present Universe.

As Momentum was resolved within such an extreme configuration, the relationships involved could not simply remain unchanged. The resolution of one Momentum changes

the corresponding effective Distance, and the altered relationship changes the configuration in which other relationships exist. Their Difference and Distance need not remain what they were before, and the effectiveness of the Momentum associated with them can consequently change as well.

Momentum Resolution therefore produces relational rearrangement.

At the scale of the early Universe, such rearrangement need not remain local. The relationships involved were not isolated events distributed across an otherwise independent background. Changes in one part of the network altered the relational conditions of other parts, while those changes in turn participated in still broader reconstruction. The result could be a Universe-wide transformation in which many resolution paths became effective simultaneously and continually modified one another.

This is the sense in which the Big Bang can be read as ****global diffusion of Momentum****.

The word ***diffusion*** must be used carefully. Momentum is not a substance that was once stored in a small region and then spread through an already existing space. Nor does global diffusion imply a single outward vector radiating from a geometric center. What becomes broader is the scope of relational rearrangement through which Momentum is resolved and different relational configurations become effective.

The initial relational concentration does not remain intact.

As Momentum is resolved, effective Distance increases in the corresponding relationships, while the surrounding relational configuration is reconstructed. That reconstruction changes the conditions of other Momentum, which can then become more or less strongly effective. Across the network, many such changes can occur together, producing a progressively differentiated relational configuration.

Observed geometrically, some aspects of this transformation can appear as increasing separation.

But increasing geometric separation and increasing effective Distance must remain distinct.

When Momentum is resolved in a relationship, the effective Distance associated with that Momentum increases. This does not mean that every Structure in the Universe must move geometrically away from every other Structure. Countless Momentum coexist at different scales and in different directions. Some Structures move apart. Others move closer together. Some become strongly bound and form an Island. Some enter rotational relationships. Some Islands separate, while others combine.

Global Momentum Resolution therefore cannot be reduced to every local object moving outward in the same geometric direction.

“Global” does not designate a geometric direction. It refers to the broader relational process through which the extreme concentration of the early Universe is transformed into a more widely differentiated configuration, within which local Momentum can become effective in many different directions.

Global and local processes do not exclude one another.

Broad Momentum Resolution in the early Universe participates in rearranging the relational network, and that rearrangement changes the configuration of local Difference and Distance. Under those altered local conditions, which Momentum becomes effective can also change. At the same time, local Momentum Resolution and the formation, transformation, and separation of Islands alter surrounding relationships and thereby participate in the continuing change of the broader relational configuration.

Through these interacting processes, the Universe can develop configurations in which increasingly many local Structures become distinguishable.

In the extreme concentration of the early Universe, there is no need to assume that clearly bounded Islands such as the stars, planets, and galaxies of the present Universe already existed in their later forms. As the relational network was rearranged and the configuration of Difference and Distance changed, relatively strong binding Momentum relationships could persist within particular local configurations. Acting together with other Momentum, those relationships could constrain, cancel, and rearrange one another sufficiently for relatively persistent Islands to emerge.

Cosmic diffusion therefore does not mean dispersion alone.

Dispersion and binding can occur simultaneously.

At broader scales, previously concentrated relationships can become increasingly differentiated, while at local scales new binding relationships can form. Effective Distance may increase in one relationship while a more strongly effective Momentum appears in another. Macroscopic separation and the formation of local Structure can therefore coexist within the same changing Universe.

The formation of a star need not be treated as an exception occurring against cosmic diffusion.

Galaxies can form, stars can emerge within them, and planets and smaller Structures can form in turn without being separated from the broader relational transformation. Changes in the global relational configuration alter local conditions, and within those

altered conditions relatively strong Momentum relationships can form new Islands.

The formation of a local Island does not, in turn, suspend broader Equalization.

Momentum Resolution continues within the Island. Momentum also remains effective in relationships between the Island and its surroundings, while those local changes participate in changing the surrounding configuration. A relatively persistent Structure is therefore not a pocket in which the broader transformation of the Universe has somehow stopped.

For the same reason, the history of the Universe need not be pictured as a simple process in which every Difference progressively disappears into one uniform state.

Momentum Resolution is not a subtraction in which Difference is removed one by one until no relationships remain. When one relationship changes, the conditions of other relationships change with it. A new local Difference can become significant. Momentum that was previously weak can become strongly effective. New Islands can form.

Resolution produces rearrangement, and rearrangement changes the effectiveness of other Momentum.

Equalization therefore need not be understood as a linear descent toward a predetermined static final state. If broad global Momentum Resolution beginning from the early Universe produced extensive differentiation, that differentiation itself can provide the conditions under which numerous local Equalization processes become effective.

The Universe we observe today is, in this sense, not debris left behind after the Big Bang ended.

There is an enormous physical difference between the extreme relational concentration of the early Universe and the complex, differentiated Universe of the present. The temperature and density of the early Universe were radically different from those of today; the states of particles and radiation were different, and the physical conditions and scales under which change occurred were also profoundly different. DISTANCE does not erase these differences.

It asks whether the basic relational process connecting those states must itself be regarded as completely different.

Momentum was not present only in the early Universe.

It remains present today.

Equalization did not occur only immediately after the Big Bang. Momentum continues to be resolved across countless scales, and relational networks continue to be reconstructed. While macroscopic relations among galaxies change, stars form and disappear

within galaxies. Planets rotate around stars. Within planets, configurations of matter continue to change. At still smaller scales, other Momentum remain effective within their own relational conditions.

The physical forms and scales are different, but the Universe has not become relationally inactive.

Cosmology expresses the enormous difference between the early and present Universe through cosmic time, the scale factor, spatial separation, and the evolving states of matter and radiation. Those descriptions remain indispensable at the level of observation and mathematical theory. DISTANCE does not require them to be discarded.

It asks only whether geometric change must be assigned the first explanatory priority.

A change in spatial scale can instead be read as one observable expression of a changing relational network. This is precisely where the interpretation of time as an observational scale of change and space as a geometric scale of relational configuration becomes relevant. Cosmic time allows us to order and compare the enormous transformations between the early and present Universe, while cosmic scales and spatial separations allow us to express their macroscopic geometric differences.

But time did not pull the Universe toward its present configuration.

Nor must the explanatory starting point be fixed at space expanding by itself and thereby causing relationships to change. For DISTANCE, the central process is the continuing Momentum Resolution and relational rearrangement through which the configuration itself changes.

The Big Bang therefore cannot be the moment at which Momentum first appeared. Momentum is always present.

There is no need to assume a completely motionless Universe before the Big Bang in which Momentum was absent until motion suddenly began. What DISTANCE reads under the name *Big Bang* is instead **a global transition in which Universe-wide Momentum Resolution paths became broadly effective within an extremely concentrated relational configuration, initiating large-scale rearrangement of the relational network**.

The increasing separation of Structures within that transformation is not an escape into empty space.

Changes in relational configuration can become observable as geometric separation.

Nor must this process be regarded as something completed in a single initial moment. The present Universe continues to change. While countless local Islands form, persist, transform, and disintegrate, the broader relational network continues to be reconstructed.

Some Momentum are resolved, and those changes alter the effectiveness of other Momentum. Local changes participate in broader configurations, while broader changes modify the conditions of local relationships.

The Universe we observe today is therefore not a static stage remaining after an ancient explosion.

In the DISTANCE interpretation, it is ****the present configuration through which ongoing global Momentum Resolution is expressed****.

The early Universe and the present Universe are not separated by an independently flowing river of time. They are different relational configurations. One was characterized by extreme relational concentration. The other contains countless Islands, Distance at many scales, and Momentum of different directions intertwined within an immensely differentiated relational network.

The transformation between them is more than the occupation of a larger amount of space. Relationships changed. Momentum was resolved, and that resolution changed other relationships. Within the resulting rearrangements, new local Difference, new effective directionalities, and new Islands continually became distinguishable.

The Big Bang does not mark the point at which that immense transformation ended. From the perspective of DISTANCE, it identifies the earliest and most extreme configuration of global Momentum Resolution that we can trace within the history of the observable Universe.

And the present Universe is not what remains after that global relational change.

It is the form that change is taking now.

12 Light — The Boundary of Momentum Resolution and Its Observable Expression

Light is strange.

We learn that light is the fastest-moving phenomenon we can observe. In vacuum, its speed is approximately 300,000 kilometers per second, and the locally measured speed of light in vacuum remains the same regardless of the motion of the source or the observer. Unlike a ball thrown from a moving car, or a wave observed from a moving boat, its speed cannot be obtained simply by adding or subtracting the observer's motion.

Modern physics has dealt with this strangeness with extraordinary success. Special relativity shows how measurements of time and space must differ among inertial ob-

servers while the speed of light in vacuum remains invariant, and its consequences have been confirmed with remarkable precision in observation and experiment. Modern field theory likewise does not treat light merely as tiny particles flying through empty space. Electromagnetic field dynamics and the quantum description of photons provide highly successful accounts of the generation, propagation, and absorption of light.

DISTANCE does not ask whether this physics is right or wrong.

It asks a different question.

****What is it that moves when we speak of the “movement” of light?****

At first, the question may seem unnecessary. Light leaving the Sun reaches Earth roughly eight minutes later. By sending a laser pulse to the Moon and measuring the time required for the reflected signal to return, we can determine the Earth–Moon distance. Light is emitted, propagated, reflected, and absorbed. There is nothing problematic about describing these phenomena as light moving through space.

The difficulty begins only when that successful description is immediately taken to prescribe the only possible way in which the phenomenon must exist.

To say that light moves from one position to another already employs several concepts. There must be something distinguishable as light; the position from which it begins and the position at which it later arrives must be distinguishable; there must be a spatial separation between those positions; and there must be a temporal distinction between the earlier and later observations.

The familiar physical categories of mass, space, time, and movement are already in place.

At the macroscopic scale, this picture feels natural. A stone moves. A car moves. A planet moves. Each persists as a distinguishable Island over a sufficient interval for us to compare different positions, and we can measure the change in those positions through the scale we call time. We can therefore say that the same Structure has moved from one position in space to another.

But as we move deeper into the internal description of an Island, this picture becomes progressively less comfortable.

A stone is described in terms of molecules, molecules in terms of atoms, and atoms in terms of still smaller configurations. At those scales, the intuition of a small, self-contained object simply retaining its identity while traveling through a preexisting space becomes increasingly difficult to preserve in its ordinary macroscopic form. Quantum physics does not generally permit us to assign microscopic phenomena the same definite trajectories

and persistent object-like identities that we comfortably assign to stones and planets.

This does not mean that space, time, mass, or movement cease to be physically meaningful. It means that the scale at which those concepts can be used with ordinary macroscopic intuition is not unlimited.

Now push the thought experiment further.

Suppose we move conceptually toward increasingly shorter effective Distance and correspondingly more strongly effective Momentum. The “smallness” involved here need not mean only a smaller geometric object. A scale can also change relationally. A configuration may approach an extreme in which the categories we use to distinguish one persistent Island from another become increasingly difficult to apply in the same way.

What, then, happens to the concepts of mass, space, time, and movement at such an extreme?

The question has an interesting symmetry with another limit considered earlier. Imagine, as a conceptual boundary, a state in which every Difference has been resolved and no effective Momentum can be distinguished through further relational change. If there is no distinguishable change, the observational role of time becomes difficult to define in the ordinary sense. If there are no distinguishable relational differences through which positions and configurations can be compared, the observational role of space likewise becomes difficult to define in its familiar form.

Now consider the opposite relational extreme: extremely short effective Distance and extremely strongly effective Momentum.

The two limits are not physically identical, and DISTANCE has no basis for claiming that they are. Yet both expose the same conceptual vulnerability. The categories through which we ordinarily describe persistent objects moving through time and space may depend on the relational scale at which those distinctions remain observable.

This is where the Big Bang discussion acquires another significance.

The early Universe was described not merely as geometrically small but as an extreme relational concentration. If numerous relationships were characterized by extremely short effective Distance and strongly effective Momentum, then the relational scale of that configuration would differ profoundly from the scale at which present-day macroscopic Islands are observed.

It would be premature to claim that we know exactly what mass, space, time, or movement mean at that extreme. Modern cosmology and fundamental physics continue to investigate the limits at which our present theoretical descriptions remain applicable,

and DISTANCE does not possess a quantitative theory capable of replacing them.

The thought experiment establishes only a more limited possibility: the smallest relevant scale in DISTANCE need not be identical to the smallest geometric object.

A very short effective Distance is a relational condition, not a statement about ruler-measured separation.

This also means that two configurations that appear geometrically far apart at our observational scale need not be assumed to be equally far apart in effective Distance. Geometric separation and effective Distance are not the same measure. The distinction has already mattered in gravity and rotation; at an extreme relational scale, its implications become even more difficult to ignore.

The familiar picture of movement begins to depend on that distinction.

When we say that something travels from A to B, we usually imagine a continuous geometric space already lying between them. A is here, B is there, and the moving entity crosses the intervening separation. If necessary, we can divide the route into smaller intervals: A to an adjacent point, then to the next, and so on until B is reached.

That picture is extraordinarily useful for observed propagation.

But it becomes a stronger claim if we assume that the same geometric adjacency must also be the fundamental relational order through which the change itself becomes effective.

DISTANCE does not require that assumption.

The fact that we observe a direction of propagation, a measurable distance, and a finite arrival time does not by itself establish that the underlying relational change must ontologically proceed from geometrically adjacent A to B, then B to C, and C to D in exactly the same sense in which a macroscopic object crosses a sequence of positions.

To impose that picture in advance would quietly restore geometric space as the first explanatory background.

Light makes this problem unusually visible.

Consider emission from an atom. In established physics, when an atom undergoes an appropriate transition between energy states, the energy difference can be emitted as electromagnetic radiation. The emitted radiation propagates according to electromagnetic and quantum dynamics and may later interact with another system and be absorbed.

Nothing in this description requires us to imagine a tiny luminous pellet being mechanically repelled from the atom and then racing across empty space.

DISTANCE can take one interpretive step further while remaining explicit about its

speculative status.

Emission may be read as an event in which part of an energy difference bound within the relations of an Island is transformed into a relational state capable of propagation. The observable consequence of that transformation can later become effective in another relationship. Absorption, correspondingly, can be read as an event in which that propagating state becomes manifest again as a change in the internal relationships of another Island.

The important question then shifts.

Instead of asking only ****what object ran across the intervening space****, we can ask ****what change in relational state became effective in another relationship****.

What we call the movement of light may be the way this spreading effectiveness of relational change appears when measured through the observational scales of time and space.

The word **diffusion**, however, must be handled carefully.

The relational diffusion proposed here is not identical to the ordinary diffusion of heat or ink through water. In those cases, a distribution within an already described geometric space tends to spread and become more uniform. Light, by contrast, can propagate through ideal vacuum while preserving phase and organized structure.

****Relational diffusion**** therefore does not mean that a substance called Momentum spreads out and fills space.

Momentum is not a substance.

Nor does relational diffusion mean that an originally localized Momentum is created at one point and then carried outward through the Universe. Momentum is always present. What changes is the relational configuration in which particular Momentum become effective and the extent to which a state change in one relationship becomes effective across a broader relational network.

Even here, we should resist inserting a hidden geometric mechanism.

Relational diffusion need not be defined ontologically as a process in which a change first occurs at geometric point A, then passes to adjacent B, then to C, and finally to D. The moment we make that sequence fundamental, we have again placed preexisting geometric space beneath the relational process we were attempting to examine.

Observed light unquestionably has a direction of propagation. There is a measurable interval between emission and arrival. A greater geometric separation corresponds to a greater travel time under the appropriate physical conditions. In vacuum, the relation is

expressed through the remarkably stable boundary we call c .

All of this remains physically real at the level of observation and established theory.

The open question is what explanatory priority should be assigned to it.

From the DISTANCE perspective, c can cautiously be considered not only as the measured propagation speed of light, but as a possible observable boundary in the rate at which relational state change can become effective within the spacetime scale available to us.

This is an interpretation, not a new physical law.

DISTANCE does not derive c , does not provide a field equation from which its value follows, and does not establish that every relational change in the Universe is governed by a newly proposed mechanism of this kind. The invariant speed of light remains an established physical result described by relativity and field theory. The relational reading asks only whether the significance of that boundary might be interpreted differently without altering the observation itself.

This also removes the need to make light an absolute entity.

Light is extraordinarily important to human observation. Much of what we know about distant astronomical Structures reaches us through electromagnetic radiation. Our instruments measure light with exceptional precision, and the invariant speed associated with it lies at the foundation of relativistic causal structure.

But the fact that light reveals a boundary so clearly does not mean that light itself must be the most fundamental constituent of the Universe.

There may be relational phenomena that our sensory systems do not directly detect, and physical theories already describe many interactions and states that are not reducible to visible light. DISTANCE therefore has no reason to privilege light as the unique form through which Momentum Resolution can become observable.

Light may instead be one especially clear phenomenon at the boundary where our familiar categories of movement, time, space, and persistent objecthood begin to expose their dependence on observational scale.

This possibility also changes the question of whether light “moves.”

At our scale, it certainly does.

We observe propagation. We measure direction, distance, and arrival time. We can predict when a signal emitted at one place will reach another. All of these observations are real within the spacetime framework through which physical events are measured.

But those observations do not necessarily require **one identical entity to change its

location by passing through a pre-given physical space** as the only possible account of what occurs.

DISTANCE can leave another possibility open.

The phenomenon observed as light may be **relational diffusion**, in which a change in one relational state becomes effective as change in another relationship. When that diffusion is measured through time and space, it appears as propagation at a finite speed. Light may be one of the clearest observable expressions of that boundary.

Not because light is the absolute entity of the Universe.

Perhaps because it is through light that human observers have been able to see that boundary most clearly.

The deepest question raised by light, then, may not end with whether it is a particle or a wave. Beneath that distinction lies another question:

**Down to what Distance scale does what we call “movement” remain movement?*

13 The Universality of Momentum Resolution

Stones fall and planets rotate, while light is observed to propagate across the enormous intervals we call space. Stars and galaxies form, and different Structures become bound or separate. Physics uses different names and theories to describe these phenomena. Classical mechanics works with astonishing accuracy for the motion of ordinary objects, but very high velocities or strong gravitational conditions require relativity, while at extremely small scales the language of quantum mechanics becomes necessary and familiar intuitions about position, trajectory, and even a single independent object become difficult to preserve unchanged.

These differences are real, and phenomena at different scales should not be forced into the same form. An atom is not a miniature solar system, nor is a galaxy an enormous atom. Planetary revolution and electronic states cannot be described by the same geometric model, and the propagation of light cannot be treated in exactly the same way as the movement of a stone. As the scale of a phenomenon changes, the observable variables and conditions of interaction change, and so does the mathematical framework required to describe them.

When DISTANCE speaks of universality, it does not claim that these differences disappear. It begins instead by acknowledging them fully and then asking whether the fact that observable forms and the theories describing them differ necessarily means that

the basic processes of relational change beneath them must also be entirely different.

The phenomena considered so far have looked very different from one another. Mass was connected with how persistently a Structure maintains densely bound relationships. Gravity could be read as a relational directionality in which particular Momentum becomes relatively strongly effective around such a Structure. Inertia revealed how an already effective directionality can persist when changes capable of substantially modifying it remain comparatively small, while linear motion appeared as the geometric expression of a directionality that remains dominant through successive relational changes.

Rotation looked different again. There, directionality did not remain fixed but was continuously reconstructed. A center became meaningful not necessarily as an independent cause placed before the motion, but as a relational reference revealed by the recurring organization of those directional changes. Circles and spheres showed how multidirectional relationships can appear geometrically symmetric when no particular direction persistently dominates the overall configuration, while centripetal and centrifugal became distinguishable as different observational directions within a rotational relationship.

Time and space then shifted the scale of the question itself. They remained indispensable to physical description and measurement, but they did not have to be assigned the role of first causes producing relational change. Time could be read as a scale through which change is compared, while space could express the geometric complexity of relational configurations. The Big Bang extended this reading toward the largest historical transformation accessible to observation, and light pushed it toward a boundary where even the ordinary intuition of an identical entity moving through a pre-given space became difficult to treat as the only possible interpretation.

Nothing in this progression requires these phenomena to share one physical mechanism.

The equations describing gravitational motion are not the equations describing electromagnetic propagation. Quantum probability cannot be replaced by the trajectory of a classical object. Relativistic spacetime geometry cannot simply be rewritten as the mechanics of a rotating wheel. The mathematical frameworks remain different because the observable phenomena, scales, and interaction conditions are different.

The universality at issue is therefore not ****universality of form****.

It is ****universality of an interpretive principle****.

Across different physical situations, we repeatedly encounter distinguishable Difference, Distance associated with those unresolved conditions, Momentum expressed as ob-

servable directionality, and changes in which Momentum becomes effective as the relational configuration is reconstructed. Momentum is resolved, the corresponding effective Distance increases, and that change modifies the conditions under which other Momentum become effective. The observable result can be falling, rotation, persistence, propagation, binding, separation, or the formation and transformation of a Structure.

The forms differ because the relationships differ.

The principle need not.

This distinction is essential if universality is not to become reductionism. To say that a stone and a photon can both be interpreted through Momentum Resolution does not mean that a photon is secretly a very small stone. To say that a galaxy and an atom both involve relational configurations does not mean that they possess the same internal architecture. Universality does not erase scale. It asks whether a common relational grammar can remain meaningful even as scale radically changes what becomes observable.

Scale itself, moreover, is not only a matter of geometric size.

A human observer can treat a stone as one Island while ignoring most of the changes occurring within it. At another observational scale, the same stone can be distinguished into crystals, molecules, atoms, and still finer physical configurations. At each scale, different relations become observable, different distinctions become significant, and the boundary of what counts as one persistent Structure can change.

The Island visible at one scale need not be the Island visible at another.

This does not make either observation false. It means that persistence is relational and scale-dependent. A configuration can remain sufficiently stable to be treated as one Structure at a macroscopic scale while containing intense relational change at smaller scales. Conversely, many local Structures can participate in a broader configuration that itself becomes distinguishable as another Island.

A planet is one Island at one scale and a vast relational network at another. A galaxy can likewise be treated as one Structure while containing enormous numbers of stars and other configurations whose local Momentum remain active. The persistence of the larger Structure does not require the disappearance of Momentum within it.

Universality must therefore accommodate both persistence and change.

The existence of a relatively stable Island does not imply that Equalization has stopped there. Strong binding Momentum can coexist with a relative Momentum lull at the scale of the overall configuration, while numerous internal and external Momentum remain effective. The Island persists because some aspects of its relational configuration

change less than the surrounding conditions, not because it has escaped from Momentum Resolution.

Nor does the existence of local Islands imply that the broader relational process has fragmented into independent pieces.

Changes across a broader relational network alter the conditions under which local Difference, Distance, and Momentum are configured. Local Momentum Resolution simultaneously changes relationships with the surroundings and thereby participates in the continuing reconstruction of the broader network. The two scales are neither independent nor reducible to a simple sequence in which one acts first and the other merely follows. They coexist, constrain, and modify one another within the same changing Universe.

This is why the same interpretive principle can appear differently at different scales without requiring identical observable results.

At one scale, the balance among Momentum may produce a relatively persistent Island. At another, a particular directionality may become strongly effective and appear as macroscopic motion. In still another relation, repeated directional reconstruction may produce rotation. Under different conditions, the rearrangement may instead become observable as binding, separation, or propagation.

Universality therefore lies not in the repetition of one visible pattern, but in the possibility that different patterns can remain intelligible through the same relational grammar.

This claim must remain within a clear scientific boundary.

DISTANCE does not presently provide a new field equation that reproduces gravitational dynamics, a replacement for quantum probability, a new electromagnetic field theory, or an alternative mathematical formulation of relativistic spacetime. Those theories retain their authority where quantitative prediction and experimental verification are concerned. The fact that DISTANCE can place several phenomena within one conceptual vocabulary does not demonstrate that the phenomena have been physically unified.

A conceptual correspondence is not yet a universal physical law.

The universality proposed here is therefore an interpretive claim: despite the different mathematical descriptions required at different physical scales, it may be possible to read their observable changes through a consistent relational framework of Difference, Distance, Momentum, Equalization, and Momentum Resolution.

That consistency imposes constraints on DISTANCE itself.

If gravity is interpreted through one direction of the Momentum–Distance relation

while light requires the opposite direction, the framework has not become universal; it has merely changed its rules to accommodate different examples. If Momentum is always present when discussing inertia but must somehow be created from nothing when discussing the Big Bang, the interpretation has broken its own continuity. If geometric convergence is distinguished from effective Distance in gravity but the two are silently identified again when discussing rotation, the apparent universality is only verbal.

A universal interpretive principle must survive the differences among phenomena without changing its causal direction whenever the example changes.

Shorter effective Distance must remain associated with stronger effective Momentum. Momentum Resolution must remain associated with increasing effective Distance. Momentum must remain present even when no macroscopic motion is visible. Geometric separation must not suddenly become identical to effective Distance merely because a particular example makes that identification intuitively convenient.

Universality is therefore also a test.

Light is especially useful in this respect because it pushes the framework toward an uncomfortable boundary. It is relatively easy to speak relationally about a falling stone while still imagining a familiar object moving through familiar space. It is more difficult to preserve the same conceptual discipline when the phenomenon no longer fits that intuition comfortably. If DISTANCE must abandon its distinctions as soon as the ordinary picture of an object trajectory becomes inadequate, its universality ends exactly where the phenomena become most revealing.

The question raised by light was therefore not merely about light.

It exposed the possibility that geometric scale and relational Distance scale need not coincide, and that the observable propagation of change need not be interpreted only through the intuition of an identical object crossing a pre-given sequence of positions. Whether that possibility can ultimately be developed into a physical theory is a separate question. For the present argument, its significance lies in showing how far a relational interpretation can be extended without reversing its own principles.

The same caution applies in the opposite direction, toward larger and more complex Structures.

As relationships multiply, the observable result need not become simpler. The repeated operation of a common relational principle does not imply repeated production of the same form. Every resolution changes the configuration in which other Momentum become effective, so increasing relational complexity can generate increasingly diverse observable

patterns even when the underlying interpretive grammar remains unchanged.

This is why Island formation does not contradict Equalization.

A persistent Structure may appear while Momentum Resolution continues, because the resolution of some Momentum reconstructs the conditions of others. Relatively strong relationships can remain bound while other Momentum constrain, cancel, and rearrange one another, producing a configuration that changes only slowly relative to its surroundings. What appears as persistence at one scale can therefore coexist with continuing relational change at others.

A Universe governed by one relational grammar need not look uniform.

It can become more differentiated.

It can contain stones and stars, planets and galaxies, stable Islands and rapidly changing configurations. Different scales can require different physical theories, and different observers can distinguish different Structures. None of this by itself disproves the possibility of a common interpretive principle beneath their changes.

Universality, then, should not be sought in identical objects, identical trajectories, identical mechanisms, or identical equations. It lies, if it exists at all, in whether the same relational logic can remain intact while all of those observable forms change.

The same principle is universal not because the same result keeps returning, but because the relational grammar can persist while the relationships themselves change.

14 The Boundary of Physical Reinterpretation

The most familiar way of understanding the physical world is to distinguish observable phenomena, measure their differences, and express recurring relationships as laws. Objects fall, planets rotate, and light propagates, and although these phenomena are different, each becomes a predictable physical event through precise observation and mathematical description. This is one of the greatest achievements of modern physics. From microscopic scales beyond the direct reach of human senses to enormous cosmic scales, physics has connected observable changes and described them with remarkable accuracy.

DISTANCE also began in this physical world. Rather than first placing already given objects and forces within time and space and then asking how they move, however, it followed a different explanatory priority: what relationships are formed through Difference and Distance, and what Momentum becomes observably effective within those relationships. Viewed in this way, recurring relational structures gradually became visible among

phenomena that at first seemed entirely different—mass and gravity, inertia and linear motion, rotation and center, the Big Bang and light.

This does not turn the interpretations developed here into a new physical theory that replaces established physics. Momentum is not proposed as a new measurable quantity intended to replace momentum in Newtonian mechanics, and effective Distance is not another length variable intended to replace geometric distance measured in meters. Reinterpreting gravity through Momentum Resolution does not make the field equations of general relativity unnecessary, nor does raising the possibility of interpreting light as the diffusion of relational state change discard the explanations of electromagnetism or quantum field theory.

What matters instead is that the explanatory priority through which these phenomena are viewed can change while their physical descriptions remain intact. The fact that mass can be measured does not require mass to be placed as a primary property independent of relationships. The fact that motion can be described precisely in geometric space does not establish that space must therefore exist as a cause prior to every relationship. Nor does the fact that the propagation speed of light can be measured with extraordinary precision require us to conclude that it must be understood only as the passage of one identical entity across a pre-given space.

Once these distinctions are preserved, the physical phenomena remain while the questions asked of them begin to change. Instead of asking only why an object moves in a particular direction, we can ask what relationships make that directionality effective. Instead of asking only why a Structure persists, we can examine how multiple Momentum constrain and cancel one another while sustaining its configuration. Alongside measuring whether two objects are geometrically near or far, we can distinguish the effective Distance within their relationship; alongside measuring when a change occurs, we can separately ask from what Difference the directionality of that change arises.

The position of motion within the argument also begins to shift.

When we first think of Momentum, it is natural to imagine a moving object. A falling stone, a moving car, or an orbiting planet displays clear directionality, and the change is easy to observe. Physical motion is indeed one of the most intuitive windows through which Momentum can be considered. When an Island changes its position and its trajectory appears on the coordinates of time and space, directionality becomes especially clear.

Yet it has gradually become evident that Momentum and movement are not identical.

Inertia did not require Momentum to appear suddenly when a new force was applied, while rotation showed that the continuing reconstruction of relationships among multiple Momentum could matter more than one fixed direction of movement. Even when an Island maintains approximately the same form for a long period, the Momentum within it do not disappear; numerous relationships can constrain and cancel one another while producing a relatively persistent configuration.

Light made this distinction even sharper. The light we observe unquestionably propagates, and both distance and arrival time can be measured. Yet whether that observation necessarily requires space, time, and the geometric movement of an identical entity to retain exactly the same meaning at a deeper Momentum/Distance scale remains a separate question. Physical movement is a real observable phenomenon, but identifying Momentum with movement itself may unnecessarily restrict the range within which Momentum can be recognized.

How far, then, must Momentum remain confined within the language of physical motion?

The important point is not to enlarge the definition of Momentum. Momentum has already been defined as ****the observable directionality associated with unresolved Distance****. The question is therefore whether that directionality must always appear as one object moving from one position to another.

The formation of an Island makes the distinction clear. When relatively strong relational bindings coexist with other Momentum and constrain, cancel, and rearrange one another, a comparatively persistent configuration can appear at the scale of the whole. What we observe may be persistence rather than obvious movement, but that persistence does not imply an absence of Momentum. Even a stone that appears almost motionless is an Island constituted by countless Momentum relationships, and if those relationships change sufficiently, it no longer persists as the same Structure.

In this sense, Momentum is broader than physical displacement.

But the word ***broader*** must not be expanded too quickly. If everything begins to be called Momentum, explanation becomes easier only because the concept has ceased to distinguish anything. If every change is Momentum, every relationship is Momentum, and every phenomenon is ultimately declared to be Momentum, the concept has become indiscriminate rather than universal.

What is needed, therefore, is not an arbitrary expansion of scope but the preservation of the same criteria. Is there Difference? Does that Difference form an Energy Gap and

Distance? In what form does the directionality associated with that unresolved Distance become observable? Among the many coexisting Momentum, which becomes effective, and how does its Resolution change the relational configuration again?

If these criteria are maintained, physical movement remains an important form in which Momentum appears, but it need not be the only one.

The interpretation of mass already suggested this possibility. When the mass of an Island was read through the density of binding Momentum, the focus was not on how quickly the Island moved but on the internal relationships that sustained its configuration. With gravity, likewise, the question was not limited to the geometric movement through which two objects approach one another, but concerned which more strongly effective Momentum produces observable directionality within a relationship. With rotation, attention shifted from the shape of the trajectory itself to the relationships through which directionality is continuously reconstructed.

Restricting the observable expression of Momentum to movement alone would therefore be inconsistent with the interpretations already used throughout the physical argument.

It is more accurate to say that physical motion is one of the cases in which Momentum can be seen most easily. In a moving object, directionality appears directly as a trajectory and can therefore be readily distinguished by an observer. When multiple Momentum constrain and cancel one another while sustaining a Structure, by contrast, directionality may not appear as simple displacement. Yet unresolved Distance has not disappeared from those relationships.

Near this boundary of physical phenomena, the distinction opens an interesting question. We have followed Momentum from visible motion and measurable physical change. But if Momentum is not the velocity or displacement of a particular object, but the observable directionality associated with unresolved Distance, then shifting the focus of observation from the movement of an object toward changes in relational configuration may also change the range over which Momentum can be recognized.

The persistence of a Structure and its transformation may initially seem like opposite events, yet within DISTANCE neither is separable from the configuration of coexisting Momentum. Some Momentum may appear strongly as observable movement, others may constrain or cancel one another within binding relationships, and still other changes in relationships may make Momentum that were previously inconspicuous become effective.

There is no need yet to give this another name or to introduce another principle. The

same Momentum can simply be followed further: as the configuration under observation becomes more complex, how does Difference form; when different Distances coexist, which Momentum becomes observably effective; and how does the Resolution of one Momentum alter the conditions of other relationships so that different directionality can emerge?

Physical movement remains present throughout this process. Mass does not disappear, and measurements of space and time remain necessary. They may simply cease to be the only observable expressions to which attention must be confined.

How an Island maintains its configuration can become as significant as how rapidly it moves, while what it relates to, what it receives, and what it releases can become as important as what it collides with. As relationships become sufficiently complex, a change in one part can modify other internal relationships, and those changes can in turn modify relationships with the surroundings, allowing directionality to appear in forms that can no longer be expressed adequately through a simple trajectory.

Where unresolved Distance and observable directionality remain, the question of Momentum does not disappear. It may, in fact, become more frequent.

Perhaps the reason Momentum has so far been most readily recognized in physical motion is not that it exists only there, but that **physical motion presents it in its simplest and clearest observable form**. Directionality is readily visible in a falling stone, can be measured repeatedly in a planetary orbit, and reaches an extraordinarily precise observational boundary in the propagation of light. But not every relationship in the Universe reveals itself through such a simple trajectory.

Some relationships sustain a Structure, others transform it, while still others participate in continuous exchanges with the surroundings through which configurations not previously present can emerge. As such processes become more complex, Momentum need not disappear; what may change is the way in which it must be read.

The boundary reached by following physical phenomena this far is therefore less a grand conclusion than a change in the range of observation. Momentum was easiest to see in motion, but there may be Momentum that remains invisible when motion alone is observed. The question is no longer how far the concept can simply be extended, but whether **the same relational grammar can be preserved when we begin to look at more complex Islands**.

Where the movement of objects begins to appear instead as changing relationships, and simple trajectories give way to the persistence and reconstruction of complex configurations, Difference and Distance do not disappear. As long as unresolved Distance

remains, the directionality associated with it may become observable in other forms. Physical motion was the clearest window through which Momentum could be seen. But it need not be the only window.